Course Notes

Applied Abstract Algebra
Quiver Theory

Instructor:

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TA:

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Contents

Chapter 1

Lecture 1

Course Information

Main topic: Representation theory of quivers.

Office hours: Mon: 12:30-14:30. Office 218, Taizhou Building.

Main book: *Ralf Schiffler, Quiver Representations*

References:

- *Assem, Simson, Skowroński, Elements of the Representation Theory of Associative Algebras, Vol. 1: Techniques of Representation Theory*, Cambridge University Press.
- *Ibrahim Assem, Basic Representation Theory of Algebras.*
- *Michel Brion, Representations of Quivers.*
- *Henning Krause, Representations of Quivers via Reflection Functor.*
- *W. Crawley-Boevey, Lectures on Representations of Quivers.*
- *Ralf Schiffler, Quiver Representations.*
- *Alexander Kirillov Jr., Quiver Representations and Quiver Varieties*, Graduate Studies in Mathematics, American Mathematical Society, 2016.

Grading:

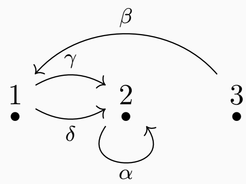
- Midterm: 30%
- Attendance: 10%
- Homework: 20%
- Final: 40%

Midterm will be on April 13th, Monday, 2026 (the 8th week).

1.1 Quivers

Definition 1.1.1. *A quiver Q is a quadruple (Q_0, Q_1, s, t), where Q_0 is a set of vertices, Q_1 is a set of arrows, and $s, t : Q_1 \to Q_0$ are two maps. For any arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$, $s(\alpha)$ is called the source of α and $t(\alpha)$ is called the target of α. For example, if $\alpha : 1 \to 2$, then $s(\alpha) = 1$ and $t(\alpha) = 2$.*

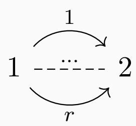
Example 1.1.2. *Let $Q_0 = \{1, 2, 3\}$, $Q_1 = \{\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta\}$. We have $s(\alpha) = 2, t(\alpha) = 2$; $s(\beta) = 3, t(\beta) = 1$; $s(\gamma) = s(\delta) = 1, t(\gamma) = t(\delta) = 2$.*



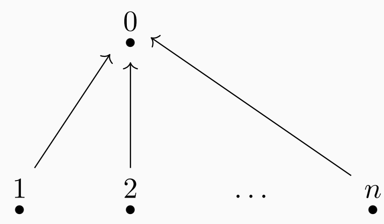
Let path $\xi = \alpha\gamma\beta$, then we have $s(\xi) = s(\beta) = 3$ and $t(\xi) = t(\alpha) = 2$.

Example 1.1.3. *Jordan quiver. The Jordan quiver consists of a single vertex and a single arrow starting and ending at this vertex. Formally, $Q_0 = \{1\}$ and $Q_1 = \{\alpha\}$ with $s(\alpha) = t(\alpha) = 1$. It is called the Jordan quiver because its representations correspond to vector spaces equipped with a linear endomorphism. The classification of such representations up to isomorphism is equivalent to the classification of square matrices up to similarity, which is given by the Jordan normal form theorem (over an algebraically closed field).*

Example 1.1.4. *r-Kronecker quiver. The r-Kronecker quiver has two vertices, say 1 and 2, and r arrows $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_r$ from 1 to 2. Thus $Q_0 = \{1, 2\}$, $Q_1 = \{\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_r\}$, with $s(\alpha_i) = 1$ and $t(\alpha_i) = 2$ for all $i = 1, \ldots, r$. It is named after Leopold Kronecker. In the case $r = 2$, the representations correspond to pairs of linear maps between two vector spaces, which can be represented by matrix pencils. Kronecker solved the classification problem for these pencils.*



Example 1.1.5. *n-subspace quiver. The n-subspace quiver consists of $n + 1$ vertices $\{0, 1, \ldots, n\}$ and n arrows $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n$ such that $s(\alpha_i) = i$ and $t(\alpha_i) = 0$ for all $i = 1, \ldots, n$. It is called the n-subspace quiver because its representations are related to configurations of subspaces. If the linear maps associated with the arrows are injective, a representation corresponds to a collection of n subspaces of the vector space associated with the central vertex.*



Definition 1.1.6. *Finite quivers. A quiver $Q = (Q_0, Q_1, s, t)$ is called finite if both the set of vertices Q_0 and the set of arrows Q_1 are finite sets.*

For the base field we assume $k = \bar{k}$. Usually we take $k = \mathbb{C}$.

1.2 Representations

Definition 1.2.1. *A representation M of a quiver Q consists of a vector space M_i for each vertex $i \in Q_0$ and a linear map $\phi_\alpha : M_{s(\alpha)} \to M_{t(\alpha)}$ for each arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$. We denote this representation by $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$.*

Example 1.2.2. *For example 1:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} M_1 \arrow[r, bend left, "\phi_\gamma"] \arrow[r, bend right, "\phi_\delta"'] & M_2 \arrow[loop below, "\phi_\alpha"] & M_3 \arrow[ll, bend right, "\phi_\beta"'] \end{tikzcd}$$

Then $M = (M_1, M_2, M_3, \phi_\gamma, \phi_\delta, \phi_\alpha, \phi_\beta)$ is a representation of the quiver Q.

Definition 1.2.3. *A representation M is called* ***finite dimensional*** *if $\dim M_i < \infty$ for all $i \in Q_0$. The tuple $\dim M = \{\dim M_i\}_{i \in Q_0}$ is called the* ***dimension vector*** *of M. An element $m \in M$ is a tuple $\{m_i\}_{i \in Q_0}$ where $m_i \in M_i$ for each $i \in Q_0$.*

Example 1.2.4. 1-*Kronecker quiver:*

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

Take k to be a field. Some representations of this quiver are:

$$M : \quad k \xrightarrow{\ 1\ } k \qquad M' : \quad k \xrightarrow{\ 0\ } k \qquad M'' : \quad k \xrightarrow{\ 0\ } 0$$

Another example is

$$\widetilde{M} : \quad k^2 \xrightarrow{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}} k^3 \ .$$

For $v = (1, 0) \in k^2$, we have

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The dimension vectors are $\underline{\dim} M = (1,1)$, $\underline{\dim} M' = (1,1)$, $\underline{\dim} M'' = (1,0)$ *and* $\underline{\dim} \widetilde{M} = (2,3)$.

1.3 Morphisms and the Category $\operatorname{Rep} Q$

Definition 1.3.1 (A Morphism between two representations of Q). *Let* $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ *and* $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ *be two representations of* Q. *A morphism* $f : M \to N$ *is a collection of linear maps* $f_i : M_i \to N_i$ *such that for every* $\phi_\alpha : M_i \to M_j$, $\alpha \in Q_1$ *the following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} M_i \arrow[r, "\phi_\alpha"] \arrow[d, "f_i"'] & M_j \arrow[d, "f_j"] \\ N_i \arrow[r, "\psi_\alpha"'] & N_j \end{tikzcd}$$

A morphism $f = (f_i)_{i \in Q_0} : M \to N$ *is called an* ***isomorphism of representations*** *if each* f_i *is an isomorphism. The class of all representations that are isomorphic to a given representation* M *is called the* ***isomorphism class*** *of* M.

Example 1.3.2. *In example of 1-Kronecker quiver, let* $f : M \to M''$, $f_1 : k \to k$ *such that* $f_1(1) = a$, *and* $f_2 : k \to 0$ *is the zero map. We can check that* f *is a morphism. Only need to check the commutativity of the following diagram:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} k \arrow[r, "1"] \arrow[d, "f_1 \quad a"'] & k \arrow[d, "0 \quad f_2"] \\ k \arrow[r, "0"'] & 0 \end{tikzcd}$$

Now we establish $g : M'' \to M$. *If* g *is a morphism, then we have* $g_1 : k \to k$ *such that* $g_1(1) = b$, *and* $g_2 : 0 \to k$ *is the zero map. To make the target diagram commute it forces* $g_1 = 0$. *Hence there are only* 0 *morphism form* M'' *to* M.

$$\begin{tikzcd} k \arrow[r, "0"] \arrow[d, "g_1 \quad b"'] & 0 \arrow[d, "0 \quad g_2"] \\ k \arrow[r, "1"'] & k \end{tikzcd}$$

$$1 \circ g_1 = 0 \Rightarrow g_1 = 0$$

Recall the definition of category:

Definition 1.3.3. *A category* $\mathcal{C}$ *consists of the following data:*

- *A class of objects, denoted by* $\operatorname{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$.
- *For any pair of objects* $X, Y \in \operatorname{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, *a set of morphisms from* X *to* Y, *denoted by* $\operatorname{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$. *If* $f \in \operatorname{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$, *we write* $f : X \to Y$.

- *For any three objects $X, Y, Z \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, a composition map:*

$$\circ : \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(Y, Z) \times \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y) \to \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Z), \quad (g, f) \mapsto g \circ f.$$

These data must satisfy the following axioms:

1. ***Associativity**: For any morphisms $f : X \to Y$, $g : Y \to Z$, and $h : Z \to W$, we have*
$$h \circ (g \circ f) = (h \circ g) \circ f.$$

2. ***Identity**: For every object $X \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, there exists an identity morphism $\mathrm{id}_X \in \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, X)$ such that for any $f : X \to Y$ and $g : Z \to X$,*
$$f \circ \mathrm{id}_X = f \quad \textit{and} \quad \mathrm{id}_X \circ g = g.$$

Denote Rep$Q$ the category of representations of Q. Then Ob(Rep$Q$) is the class of representations of Q: $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)$, and $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Rep}Q}$ is the class of morphisms $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Rep}Q}(M, N)$ from M to N.

Let $M, N \in \mathrm{Ob}(\mathrm{Rep}Q)$. Then $\mathrm{Hom}(M, N) := \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Rep}Q}(M, N)$ is a vector space over k with operations defined component-wise: for $f, g \in \mathrm{Hom}(M, N)$ and $\lambda \in k$, let $(f + g)_i = f_i + g_i$ and $(\lambda f)_i = \lambda f_i$ for all $i \in Q_0$.

Verification: Let $M = (M_i, \phi_\alpha)$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$. Since f, g are morphisms, for any arrow $\alpha : i \to j$, we have $\psi_\alpha f_i = f_j \phi_\alpha$ and $\psi_\alpha g_i = g_j \phi_\alpha$.

1. **Addition:**
$$\psi_\alpha (f + g)_i = \psi_\alpha (f_i + g_i) = \psi_\alpha f_i + \psi_\alpha g_i = f_j \phi_\alpha + g_j \phi_\alpha = (f_j + g_j)\phi_\alpha = (f + g)_j \phi_\alpha.$$
Thus $f + g \in \mathrm{Hom}(M, N)$.

2. **Scalar Multiplication:**
$$\psi_\alpha (\lambda f)_i = \psi_\alpha (\lambda f_i) = \lambda(\psi_\alpha f_i) = \lambda(f_j \phi_\alpha) = (\lambda f_j)\phi_\alpha = (\lambda f)_j \phi_\alpha.$$
Thus $\lambda f \in \mathrm{Hom}(M, N)$.

The zero morphism $0 = (0)_{i \in Q_0}$ clearly satisfies the commutativity condition. The vector space axioms follow from the structure of linear maps between vector spaces.

Example 1.3.4. *Consider*

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

$\mathrm{Hom}(M, M'') = \{(a, 0) | a \in k\} \simeq k$. $\mathrm{Hom}(M'', M) = \{0\}$.

Example 1.3.5. *Let Q be a quiver:*

$$
\begin{tikzcd}
1 \arrow[dr, "\alpha"] & & \\
& 3 & 4 \arrow[l, "\gamma"'] \\
2 \arrow[ur, "\beta"] & &
\end{tikzcd}
$$

Let M:

$$
\begin{tikzcd}
k \arrow[dr, "{\begin{bmatrix}1\\0\end{bmatrix}}"] & & \\
& k^2 & k \arrow[l, "{\begin{bmatrix}1\\1\end{bmatrix}}"'] \\
k \arrow[ur, "{\begin{bmatrix}0\\1\end{bmatrix}}"] & &
\end{tikzcd}
$$

M':

$$
\begin{tikzcd}
0 \arrow[dr, "0"] & & \\
& k & 0 \arrow[l, "0"'] \\
0 \arrow[ur, "0"] & &
\end{tikzcd}
$$

M'':

$$
\begin{tikzcd}
k \arrow[dr, "1"] & & \\
& k & k \arrow[l, "1"'] \\
k \arrow[ur, "1"] & &
\end{tikzcd}
$$

Let us check $\mathrm{Hom}(M, M')$*:*

$$
\begin{tikzcd}
k \arrow[dr, "{\begin{bmatrix}1\\0\end{bmatrix}}"] \arrow[ddd, bend right, "0"'] & & \\
& k^2 \arrow[ddd, "{[a \quad b]}"] & k \arrow[l, "{\begin{bmatrix}1\\1\end{bmatrix}}"'] \arrow[ddd, bend left, "0"] \\
k \arrow[ur, "{\begin{bmatrix}0\\1\end{bmatrix}}"] \arrow[ddd, bend right, "0"'] & & \\
0 \arrow[dr, "0"] & & \\
& k & 0 \arrow[l, "0"] \\
0 \arrow[ur, "0"] & &
\end{tikzcd}
$$

Since $M'_1 = M'_2 = M'_4 = 0$, *the maps* f_1, f_2, f_4 *are zero. Let* $f_3 = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix}$. *The commutativity conditions impose:*

$$\begin{cases} f_3\phi_\alpha = \psi_\alpha f_1 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = 0 \implies a = 0, \\ f_3\phi_\beta = \psi_\beta f_2 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = 0 \implies b = 0. \end{cases}$$

Thus $f_3 = 0$, *and* $\mathrm{Hom}(M, M') = 0$.
Let us check $\mathrm{Hom}(M, M'')$*:*

$$\begin{tikzcd}
k \arrow[dr, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}"] \arrow[ddd, bend right, "c"'] & & \\
& k^2 \arrow[ddd, "\begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix}"] & k \arrow[l, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}"'] \arrow[ddd, bend left, "e"] \\
k \arrow[ur, "\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}"] \arrow[ddd, bend right, "d"'] & & \\
k \arrow[dr, "1"] & & \\
& k & k \arrow[l, "1"] \\
k \arrow[ur, "1"] & &
\end{tikzcd}$$

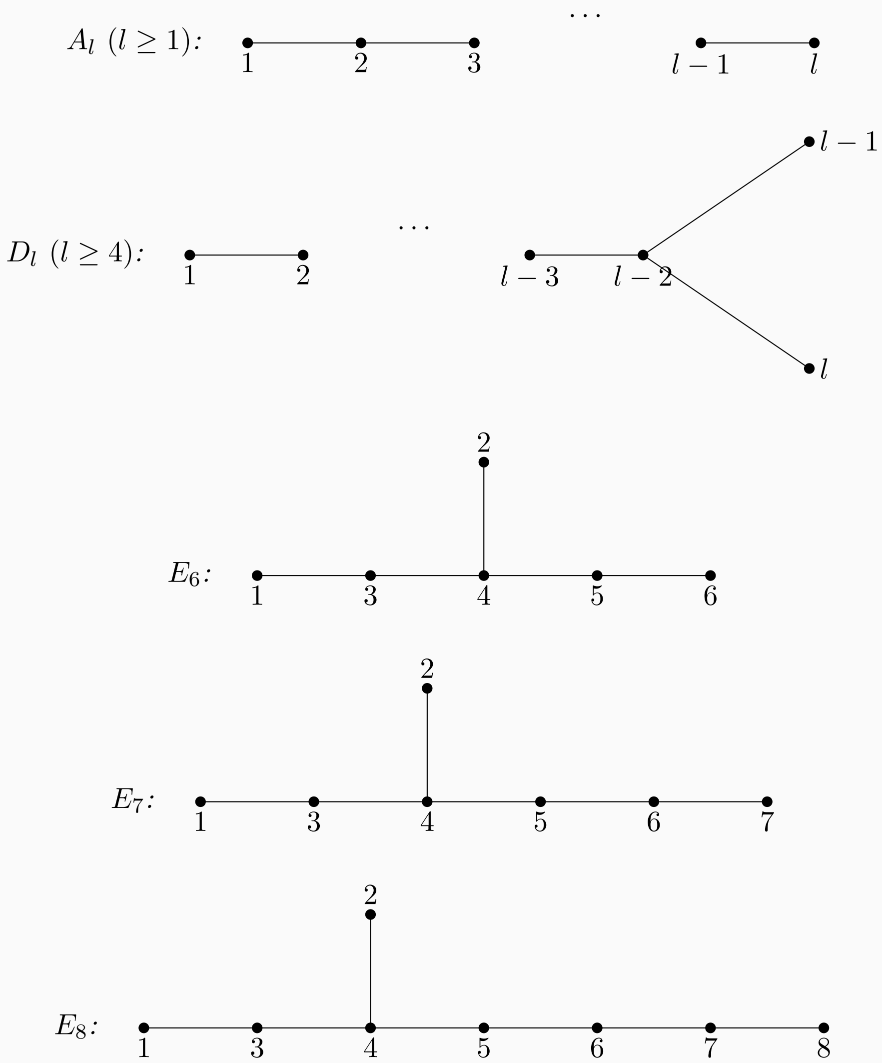
Let the morphism be given by $g_1 = [c]$, $g_2 = [d]$, $g_4 = [e]$, *and* $g_3 = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix}$. *The commutativity conditions are:*

$$\begin{cases} g_3\phi_\alpha = \psi_\alpha g_1 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = c \implies a = c, \\ g_3\phi_\beta = \psi_\beta g_2 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = d \implies b = d, \\ g_3\phi_\gamma = \psi_\gamma g_4 \implies \begin{bmatrix} a & b \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = e \implies a + b = e. \end{cases}$$

The morphism is uniquely determined by the parameters $a, b \in k$, *and hence* $\mathrm{Hom}(M, M'') \cong k^2$.

1.4 Dynkin Diagrams and Classical Quivers

Example 1.4.1. *Dynkin Diagrams:*



Example 1.4.2. 2-*Kronecker quiver:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} 1 \arrow[r, bend left] \arrow[r, bend right] & 2 \end{tikzcd}$$

Representations of this quiver:

$$\begin{tikzcd} V \arrow[r, bend left, "A"] \arrow[r, bend right, "B"'] & W \end{tikzcd}$$

Example 1.4.3. *Jordan quiver:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} 1 \arrow[loop above] \end{tikzcd}$$

Representations of this quiver:

$$\begin{tikzcd} V \arrow["A"', loop above] \end{tikzcd}$$

$A : V \to V$, the matrix representation of A is similar to a Jordan normal form (when $k = \bar{k}$).

Chapter 2

Lecture 2

2.1 Morphisms and Decompositions

Recall the definition:

Definition 2.1.1. *Let $Q = (Q_0, Q_1)$ be a quiver. A representation of Q is a collection*

$$M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1},$$

where each V_i is a vector space and each arrow $\alpha : i \to j$ is assigned a linear map

$$\varphi_\alpha \in \operatorname{Hom}(V_i, V_j).$$

Example 2.1.2. *Consider the 2-Kronecker quiver*

$$\begin{tikzcd} 1 \arrow[r, bend left] \arrow[r, bend right] & 2 \end{tikzcd}$$

and the representations

$$M : \qquad k \underset{\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}}{\overset{\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}}{\rightrightarrows}} k^2$$

and

$$N : \qquad k^2 \underset{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}}{\overset{\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}}{\rightrightarrows}} k^2$$

Denote $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$ and $N = (U_i, \psi_\alpha)_{i \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1}$. Consider the morphism $f : M \to N$. $f = (f_i)_{i \in Q_0}$. $f_i : V_i \to U_i$ and for each $\alpha : i \to j$ in Q, the following *diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} V_i \arrow[r, "\varphi_\alpha"] \arrow[d, "f_i"'] & V_j \arrow[d, "f_j"] \\ U_i \arrow[r, "\psi_\alpha"'] & U_j \end{tikzcd}$$

We use $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ *to denote the category of representations of* Q. *For our example, we have*

$$f : M \to N : f = (f_1, f_2) :$$

Let $f = (f_1, f_2) : M \to N$ *be a morphism. Write*

$$f_1 = \begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix}, \qquad f_2 = \begin{bmatrix} c & d \\ e & f \end{bmatrix}.$$

Then the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{tikzcd} k \arrow[r, shift left, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}"] \arrow[r, shift right, "\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}"'] \arrow[d, "f_1=\begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix}"'] & k^2 \arrow[d, "f_2=\begin{bmatrix} c & d \\ e & f \end{bmatrix}"] \\ k^2 \arrow[r, shift left, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}"] \arrow[r, shift right, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}"'] & k^2 \end{tikzcd}$$

Commutativity along the two arrows gives

$$f_2 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} c \\ e \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} f_1 = \begin{bmatrix} a+b \\ b \end{bmatrix},$$

and

$$f_2 \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} d \\ f \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} f_1 = \begin{bmatrix} a+b \\ a+b \end{bmatrix}.$$

Hence

$$c = d = f = a + b, \qquad e = b,$$

so

$$f = \left(\begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} a+b & a+b \\ b & a+b \end{bmatrix} \right), \qquad \dim \operatorname{Hom}(M, N) = 2.$$

This illustrates how morphisms in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ *are determined by commutative diagrams.*

Definition 2.1.3. *If $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)$ and $N = (U_i, \psi_\alpha)$ are representations of Q, then their direct sum is*

$$M \oplus N = \left(V_i \oplus U_i, \begin{bmatrix} \varphi_\alpha & 0 \\ 0 & \psi_\alpha \end{bmatrix} \right).$$

Inductively, one may form finite direct sums $M_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus M_r$.

Definition 2.1.4. *A representation M is called indecomposable if it cannot be written as a direct sum of two non-zero representations of Q.*

Remark 2.1.5. *For quiver representations, indecomposable and irreducible are different notions; they do not have to coincide.*

Example 2.1.6. *Consider the quiver*

$$\begin{tikzcd} 1 \arrow[r] & 2 & 3 \arrow[l] \end{tikzcd}$$

and the following representations:

$$M: \quad \begin{tikzcd} k \arrow[r, "1"] & k & 0 \arrow[l, "0"'] \end{tikzcd}$$

$$N: \quad \begin{tikzcd} k^2 \arrow[r, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}"] & k^2 & k \arrow[l, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}"'] \end{tikzcd}$$

Then

$$M \oplus N: \quad \begin{tikzcd} k \oplus k^2 \arrow[r, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}"] & k \oplus k^2 & 0 \oplus k \arrow[l, "\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}"'] \end{tikzcd}$$

Indeed, identifying

$$k \oplus k^2 \cong k^3, \qquad k \oplus k^2 \cong k^3, \qquad 0 \oplus k \cong k,$$

we may rewrite this as

$$\begin{tikzcd} k^3 \arrow[r, "\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}"] & k^3 & k \arrow[l, "\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}"'] \end{tikzcd}$$

Example 2.1.7. *Consider the Jordan quiver:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} \bullet \arrow[loop above] \end{tikzcd}$$

Let A, B, C be three $n \times n$ matrices. Where C denotes an isomorphism (C is invertible). We have the following diagram:

$$\begin{tikzcd} \overset{\bullet}{V} \arrow[loop above, "A"] \arrow[d, "C"'] \\ \overset{\bullet}{V} \arrow[loop below, "B"] \end{tikzcd} \qquad \begin{tikzcd} V \arrow[r, "A"] \arrow[d, "C"'] & V \arrow[d, "C"] \\ V \arrow[r, "B"'] & V \end{tikzcd}$$

Which shows that A and B are similar: $A = C^{-1}BC$. Hence the isomorphism classes are controlled by Jordan normal form, and the indecomposable representations correspond exactly to single Jordan blocks.

To describe $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ we will need to describe all isomorphism classes of indecomposable representations.

Theorem 2.1.8 (Krull–Schmidt)**.** *Any finite representation $M \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$ can be decomposed into finite number of indecomposable representations and its decomposition is unique up to order.*

Proof. For a finite-dimensional representation $M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha)$, define

$$|M| := \sum_{i \in Q_0} \dim_k M_i.$$

We first prove the existence of a decomposition into indecomposable representations by induction on $|M|$.

If $|M| = 0$, then $M = 0$, and there is nothing to prove. If $M \neq 0$ is already indecomposable, then again there is nothing to prove. Suppose now that M is decomposable. Then there exist nonzero representations M' and M'' such that

$$M \cong M' \oplus M''.$$

Since both M' and M'' are nonzero, we have

$$|M'| < |M| \qquad \text{and} \qquad |M''| < |M|.$$

By the induction hypothesis, both M' and M'' decompose as finite direct sums of indecomposable representations. Hence M also decomposes as a finite direct sum of indecomposable representations. This proves existence.

We now prove uniqueness. The key point is the following claim:

Claim. Let X be a finite-dimensional indecomposable representation. Then every endomorphism $f \in \operatorname{End}(X)$ is either invertible or nilpotent.

Indeed, since X is finite-dimensional, Fitting's lemma applies to f. Thus for $n \gg 0$,

$$X = \ker(f^n) \oplus \operatorname{im}(f^n).$$

Both $\ker(f^n)$ and $\operatorname{im}(f^n)$ are subrepresentations of X. Since X is indecomposable, one of them must be zero. If $\ker(f^n) = 0$, then f^n is injective, hence bijective, and therefore f is invertible. If $\operatorname{im}(f^n) = 0$, then $f^n = 0$, so f is nilpotent. This proves the claim.

Now suppose that

$$M \cong M_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus M_r \qquad \text{and} \qquad M \cong N_1 \oplus \cdots \oplus N_s,$$

where all M_i and N_j are indecomposable. We must show that $r = s$ and, after a permutation, $M_i \cong N_i$ for all i.

Fix an isomorphism

$$\varphi : \bigoplus_{i=1}^{r} M_i \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{j=1}^{s} N_j.$$

Let

$$\iota_i : M_i \to \bigoplus_{i=1}^{r} M_i, \quad \pi_i : \bigoplus_{i=1}^{r} M_i \to M_i,$$

and

$$\iota'_j : N_j \to \bigoplus_{j=1}^{s} N_j, \quad \pi'_j : \bigoplus_{j=1}^{s} N_j \to N_j$$

be the canonical injections and projections.

For a fixed i, we have

$$1_{M_i} = \pi_i \varphi^{-1} \varphi \iota_i = \sum_{j=1}^{s} \left(\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j\right)\left(\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i\right).$$

Thus

$$1_{M_i} = u_1 + \cdots + u_s,$$

where

$$u_j := \left(\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j\right)\left(\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i\right) \in \operatorname{End}(M_i).$$

By the claim, every endomorphism of M_i is either invertible or nilpotent. If all u_j were nilpotent, then their sum could not be the identity. Hence at least one u_j is invertible. Fix such a j. Then

$$u_j = \left(\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j\right)\left(\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i\right)$$

is an automorphism of M_i. It follows that

$$\pi'_j \varphi \iota_i : M_i \to N_j$$

is a split monomorphism (i.e. a monomorphism that has a left inverse), and

$$\pi_i \varphi^{-1} \iota'_j : N_j \to M_i$$

is a split epimorphism (i.e. a epimorphism that has a right inverse). Therefore M_i is isomorphic to a direct summand of N_j. (For example, let c be the left inverse of a, then $\forall y \in N_j$ we have $y = a(c(y)) + (y - a(c(y)))$ and $a(c(y)) \in a(M_i)$ and $y - a(c(y)) \in \ker(c)$. Furthermore, $a(M_i) \cap \ker(c) = 0$). Since N_j is indecomposable, we conclude that

$$M_i \cong N_j.$$

Thus each M_i is isomorphic to some N_j. By symmetry, each N_j is isomorphic to some M_i. After reordering, we may assume

$$M_1 \cong N_1.$$

Cancelling these isomorphic summands, we obtain

$$M_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus M_r \cong N_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus N_s.$$

Repeating the argument inductively, we obtain

$$r = s$$

and, after a suitable permutation,

$$M_i \cong N_i \qquad \text{for all } 1 \leq i \leq r.$$

Therefore the decomposition of M into indecomposable representations is unique up to permutation and isomorphism of the summands. □

2.2 Kernel and Cokernel in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$

Recall in linear algebra:

Definition 2.2.1. *Let $f : V \to W$ be a linear map. The* kernel *of f is* $\ker f = \{v \in V : f(v) = 0\}$.

Definition 2.2.2. *Let $f : V \to W$ be a linear map. The* image *of f is* $\operatorname{im} f = \{w \in W : w = f(v)$ *for some* $v \in V\}$.

Definition 2.2.3. *Let $f : V \to W$ be a linear map. The* cokernel *of f is the quotient space* $\operatorname{coker} f = W/\operatorname{im} f$.

Definition 2.2.4. *Let $f : V \to W$ be a linear map. The* coimage *of f is the quotient space* $\operatorname{coim} f = V/\ker f$.

The cokernel is defined using the image; below we will use $\operatorname{im} f_i$ in the same way for representations.

From now on we consider kernel and cokernel in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$.

2.2.1 Kernel in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$.

Definition 2.2.5. *Let $f : M \to N$ be a morphism in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$, with $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$. The* kernel *of f is the representation $\ker f = (L_i, \chi_\alpha)$ where*

$$L_i = \ker f_i, \qquad \chi_\alpha = \varphi_\alpha|_{L_i} \quad \text{for each arrow } \alpha : i \to j.$$

So for each $v_i \in L_i$, $\chi_\alpha(v_i) = \varphi_\alpha(v_i)$.

Lemma 2.2.6. *With the notation above, $\ker f$ is a representation of Q, i.e. for each arrow $\alpha : i \to j$ we have $\chi_\alpha : L_i \to L_j$ is well-defined.*

Proof. For any $v_i \in L_i$ we have $f_i(v_i) = 0$. By commutativity of the morphism f,

$$f_j\big(\chi_\alpha(v_i)\big) = f_j\big(\varphi_\alpha(v_i)\big) = \psi_\alpha\big(f_i(v_i)\big) = \psi_\alpha(0) = 0.$$

Hence $\chi_\alpha(v_i) \in \ker f_j = L_j$, so $\chi_\alpha : L_i \to L_j$ is well-defined. $\square$

Remark 2.2.7. *The inclusion $L_i \hookrightarrow V_i$ at each vertex defines a morphism $\ker f \to M$ (i.e. a monomorphism). The following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} L_i & \xrightarrow{\chi_\alpha} & L_j \\ \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{incl.}} & & \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{incl.}} \\ V_i & \xrightarrow{\varphi_\alpha} & V_j \end{array}$$

2.2.2 Cokernel in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$.

Definition 2.2.8. *Let $f : M \to N$ be a morphism in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$, with $M = (V_i, \varphi_\alpha)$ and $N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$. The* cokernel *of f is the representation $\operatorname{coker} f = (R_i, \nu_\alpha)$ where $R_i = N_i / \operatorname{Im} f_i$, and for each arrow $\alpha : i \to j$ the map $\nu_\alpha : R_i \to R_j$ is defined by*

$$\nu_\alpha\big(n_i + f_i(V_i)\big) = \psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(V_j).$$

Lemma 2.2.9. *The maps ν_α above are well-defined, and (R_i, ν_α) is a representation of Q.*

Proof. Suppose $n_i + f_i(V_i) = n_i' + f_i(V_i)$. Then $n_i - n_i' \in f_i(V_i)$, so $n_i - n_i' = f_i(v_i)$ for some $v_i \in V_i$. By commutativity of f,

$$\psi_\alpha(n_i - n_i') = \psi_\alpha\big(f_i(v_i)\big) = f_j\big(\varphi_\alpha(v_i)\big) \in f_j(V_j).$$

Hence $\psi_\alpha(n_i) - \psi_\alpha(n_i') \in f_j(V_j)$, so $\psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(V_j) = \psi_\alpha(n_i') + f_j(V_j)$. Thus ν_α is well-defined. $\square$

Remark 2.2.10. *The quotient maps $N_i \to R_i$ define a morphism $N \to \operatorname{coker} f$ (i.e. a surjective morphism). The following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{array}{ccc} N_i & \xrightarrow{\psi_\alpha} & N_j \\ \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{proj.}} & & \big\downarrow{\scriptstyle \text{proj.}} \\ R_i & \xrightarrow{\nu_\alpha} & R_j \end{array}$$

Chapter 3

Lecture 3

3.1 Subrepresentations and Indecomposability

Definition 3.1.1. *Recall that for a morphism $f : M \to N$, we have a representation*

$$\ker f \xhookrightarrow{incl.} M$$

A subrepresentation of M is representation L such that $f : L \to M$ is a monomorphism.

Example 3.1.2. *For the quiver* $1 \longrightarrow 2$ *We have trivial representation*

$$0 \xrightarrow{0} 0$$

The following 3 representations are non-trivial

$$k \xrightarrow{0} 0 \quad 0 \xrightarrow{0} k \quad k \xrightarrow{1} k$$

Denoted by S_1, S_2, M.
First two representations are irreducible and indecomposable, the last one is reducible but indecomposable.
To check it, first it is obvious that if M has non-trivial subrepresentations, the only possible ones are S_1 and S_2. For S_1 consider the following diagram:

$$\begin{tikzcd} k \arrow[r, "0"] \arrow[d, "a"'] & 0 \arrow[d, "b"] \\ k \arrow[r, "1"] & k \end{tikzcd}$$

Then a=b=0, it is impossible to construct inclusion.

But if we consider S_2:

$$\begin{tikzcd} 0 \arrow[r, "0"] \arrow[d, "a"'] & k \arrow[d, "b"] \\ k \arrow[r, "1"] & k \end{tikzcd}$$

Then $a = b \cdot 0 = 0$ and b is arbitrary (then we have a monomorphism). Hence we come to the conclusion that $\mathrm{Hom}(S_1, M) = 0$ and $\mathrm{Hom}(S_2, M) = k$. In other words S_2 is a subrepresentation of M and hence M is reducible.
But if S_2 is a direct summand of M, then since S_1 is not a submodule, we can not have $M = S_1 \oplus S_2$. Hence M is indecomposable.

3.2 Kernel, Cokernel, and the First Isomorphism Theorem

Definition 3.2.1 (Universal property of the kernel)**.** *Let $f : M \to N$ be a morphism of representations. A kernel of f is a morphism $g : L \to M$ such that $f \circ g = 0$ and such that, for every morphism $h : X \to M$ with $f \circ h = 0$, there exists a unique morphism $u : X \to L$ making the diagram commute:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} X \arrow[r, dashed, "u"] \arrow[dr, "h"'] & L \arrow[d, "g"] & \\ & M \arrow[r, "f"] & N. \end{tikzcd}$$

Let us show that previous definition $\ker f = (\ker f_i = L_i, \varphi_\alpha|_{L_i})$ is equivalent to the universal property definition with $L = \ker f, g_i = incl.$ i.e. $\ker f_i \xhookrightarrow{incl.} M_i$ where $f_i g_i = 0$.

Proof. Let

$$f = (f_i) : M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha) \longrightarrow N = (N_i, \rho_\alpha)$$

be a morphism of representations. For each vertex i, set

$$L_i := \ker f_i \subseteq M_i.$$

For each arrow $\alpha : i \to j$, define

$$\psi_\alpha := \varphi_\alpha|_{L_i} : L_i \to L_j.$$

Therefore

$$L = (L_i, \psi_\alpha)$$

is a representation. Let

$$g = (g_i) : L \to M$$

be given by the inclusion maps

$$g_i : L_i = \ker f_i \hookrightarrow M_i.$$

Then for each vertex i,

$$f_i \circ g_i = 0,$$

so

$$f \circ g = 0.$$

We now show that (L, g) satisfies the universal property of the kernel.

Let

$$h = (h_i) : X = (X_i, \nu_\alpha) \to M$$

be any morphism of representations such that

$$f \circ h = 0.$$

Then for every vertex i,

$$f_i \circ h_i = 0.$$

Thus, for every $x_i \in X_i$,

$$f_i(h_i(x_i)) = 0,$$

which means that

$$h_i(x_i) \in \ker f_i = L_i.$$

Hence each h_i factors through L_i, so we may define a linear map

$$u_i : X_i \to L_i, \qquad u_i(x_i) := h_i(x_i).$$

By construction,

$$g_i \circ u_i = h_i$$

for every vertex i.

It remains to check that $u = (u_i) : X \to L$ is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : i \to j$ be an arrow and let $x_i \in X_i$. Then

$$\psi_\alpha(u_i(x_i)) = \psi_\alpha(h_i(x_i)) = \varphi_\alpha(h_i(x_i)) = h_j(\nu_\alpha(x_i)) = u_j(\nu_\alpha(x_i)).$$

Therefore

$$\psi_\alpha \circ u_i = u_j \circ \nu_\alpha$$

for every arrow α, so u is indeed a morphism of representations.

Finally, uniqueness is clear. If

$$u' = (u'_i) : X \to L$$

is another morphism such that

$$g \circ u' = h,$$

then for each vertex i,

$$g_i \circ u'_i = h_i.$$

Since $g_i : L_i \hookrightarrow M_i$ is just the inclusion map, it follows that

$$u_i'(x_i) = h_i(x_i) = u_i(x_i)$$

for all $x_i \in X_i$. Hence $u_i' = u_i$ for all i, and so $u' = u$.

Thus (L, g) satisfies the universal property of the kernel. Therefore the representation

$$L = (\ker f_i, \varphi_\alpha|_{\ker f_i})$$

with the inclusion morphism $g : L \to M$ is precisely the kernel of f.

Conversely, suppose that (L, g) is a kernel of f in the sense of the universal property. Thus

$$g = (g_i) : L = (L_i, \chi_\alpha) \to M$$

satisfies

$$f \circ g = 0.$$

Since

$$f_i \circ g_i = 0$$

for every vertex i, we have

$$g_i(L_i) \subseteq \ker f_i = K_i.$$

Hence the morphism $g : L \to M$ factors through the inclusion

$$\iota : K \to M.$$

By the universal property of (K, ι) already proved above, there exists a unique morphism

$$\theta : L \to K$$

such that

$$\iota \circ \theta = g.$$

On the other hand, since

$$f \circ \iota = 0,$$

the universal property of (L, g) implies that there exists a unique morphism

$$\eta : K \to L$$

such that

$$g \circ \eta = \iota.$$

We now show that θ and η are inverse isomorphisms. Indeed,

$$\iota \circ (\theta \circ \eta) = (\iota \circ \theta) \circ \eta = g \circ \eta = \iota.$$

But also

$$\iota \circ 1_K = \iota.$$

Since (K, ι) satisfies the universal property, the morphism from K to K factoring ι through ι is unique. Therefore

$$\theta \circ \eta = 1_K.$$

Similarly,

$$g \circ (\eta \circ \theta) = (g \circ \eta) \circ \theta = \iota \circ \theta = g,$$

and also

$$g \circ 1_L = g.$$

By the universal property of (L, g), the factorization of g through g is unique, hence

$$\eta \circ \theta = 1_L.$$

Thus θ and η are inverse isomorphisms, so

$$L \cong K.$$

Therefore any kernel of f defined by the universal property is isomorphic to the representation

$$(\ker f_i, \varphi_\alpha|_{\ker f_i}),$$

and the two definitions of the kernel are equivalent. $\square$

Analogously we have equivalent definition of coker f.

Definition 3.2.2 (Universal property of cokernel)**.** *A cokernel of f is a morphism*

$$g : N \to H$$

such that $g \circ f = 0$ and satisfying the following universal property:
for every representation Y and every morphism $h : N \to Y$ with $h \circ f = 0$, there exists a unique morphism $u : H \to Y$ such that

$$u \circ g = h.$$

Equivalently, the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{tikzcd} M \arrow[r, "f"] & N \arrow[r, "g"] \arrow[dr, "h"'] & H \arrow[d, dashed, "u"] \\ & & Y \end{tikzcd}$$

Exercise 3.2.3. *Prove the equivalence of the two definitions of* coker f*.*

Proof. Let

$$f = (f_i) : M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha) \to N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$$

be a morphism of representations. For each vertex i, define

$$H_i := N_i/f_i(M_i).$$

For each arrow $\alpha : i \to j$, define

$$\chi_\alpha\big(n_i + f_i(M_i)\big) := \psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(M_j).$$

Hence

$$H = (H_i, \chi_\alpha)$$

is a representation.

Now let

$$g = (g_i) : N \to H$$

be the natural quotient morphism, where

$$g_i : N_i \to N_i/f_i(M_i), \qquad g_i(n_i) = n_i + f_i(M_i).$$

Then for every vertex i and every $m_i \in M_i$,

$$(g_i \circ f_i)(m_i) = f_i(m_i) + f_i(M_i) = 0.$$

Thus

$$g \circ f = 0.$$

We now prove the universal property. Let

$$h = (h_i) : N \to Y = (Y_i, \eta_\alpha)$$

be a morphism such that

$$h \circ f = 0.$$

Then for each vertex i,

$$h_i \circ f_i = 0.$$

Hence h_i vanishes on $f_i(M_i)$, so it factors uniquely through the quotient $N_i/f_i(M_i)$. Therefore there exists a unique linear map

$$u_i : H_i = N_i/f_i(M_i) \to Y_i$$

such that

$$u_i(n_i + f_i(M_i)) := h_i(n_i).$$

This is well-defined because if

$$n_i + f_i(M_i) = n_i' + f_i(M_i),$$

then $n_i - n_i' = f_i(m_i)$ for some $m_i \in M_i$, and hence

$$h_i(n_i) - h_i(n_i') = h_i(f_i(m_i)) = 0.$$

By construction,

$$u_i \circ g_i = h_i$$

for every vertex i.

It remains to check that $u = (u_i) : H \to Y$ is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : i \to j$ be an arrow and let $n_i + f_i(M_i) \in H_i$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}\eta_\alpha\big(u_i(n_i + f_i(M_i))\big) &= \eta_\alpha(h_i(n_i)) = h_j(\psi_\alpha(n_i)) = u_j\big(\psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(M_j)\big) \\ &= u_j\big(\chi_\alpha(n_i + f_i(M_i))\big).\end{aligned}$$

Therefore

$$\eta_\alpha \circ u_i = u_j \circ \chi_\alpha,$$

so u is a morphism of representations.

Finally, uniqueness is clear: if

$$u' = (u_i') : H \to Y$$

also satisfies

$$u' \circ g = h,$$

then for each i,

$$u_i'(n_i + f_i(M_i)) = u_i'(g_i(n_i)) = h_i(n_i) = u_i(n_i + f_i(M_i)).$$

Thus $u_i' = u_i$ for all i, so $u' = u$.

Therefore the quotient representation

$$\big(N_i/f_i(M_i), \chi_\alpha\big)$$

with the natural projection $g : N \to H$ satisfies the universal property of the cokernel.

On the other hand, suppose

$$g = (g_i) : N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha) \to H = (H_i, \chi_\alpha)$$

is a cokernel of

$$f = (f_i) : M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha) \to N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha)$$

in the sense of the universal property.

Let

$$C := \big(N_i/f_i(M_i),\ \overline{\psi}_\alpha\big)$$

be the pointwise cokernel representation, where

$$\overline{\psi}_\alpha(n_i + f_i(M_i)) := \psi_\alpha(n_i) + f_j(M_j).$$

Let

$$\pi = (\pi_i) : N \to C$$

be the natural quotient morphism. As shown above,

$$\pi \circ f = 0.$$

Since $g : N \to H$ is a cokernel of f, applying its universal property to the morphism

$$\pi : N \to C$$

with $\pi \circ f = 0$, there exists a unique morphism

$$a : H \to C$$

such that

$$a \circ g = \pi.$$

On the other hand, since $g \circ f = 0$, for each vertex i we have

$$g_i \circ f_i = 0.$$

Thus g_i vanishes on $f_i(M_i)$, so it factors uniquely through the quotient

$$N_i/f_i(M_i).$$

Hence for each i there exists a unique linear map

$$b_i : C_i = N_i/f_i(M_i) \to H_i$$

given by

$$b_i(n_i + f_i(M_i)) := g_i(n_i).$$

These maps assemble into a morphism

$$b : C \to H,$$

because for any arrow $\alpha : i \to j$,

$$\chi_\alpha\big(b_i(n_i{+}f_i(M_i))\big) = \chi_\alpha(g_i(n_i)) = g_j(\psi_\alpha(n_i)) = b_j\big(\psi_\alpha(n_i){+}f_j(M_j)\big) = b_j\big(\overline{\psi}_\alpha(n_i{+}f_i(M_i))\big).$$

So

$$b \circ \pi = g.$$

We now show that a and b are inverse isomorphisms.

First,

$$(a \circ b) \circ \pi = a \circ (b \circ \pi) = a \circ g = \pi.$$

Also,

$$\mathrm{id}_C \circ \pi = \pi.$$

Since $\pi : N \to C$ is a cokernel of f, the uniqueness part of its universal property implies

$$a \circ b = \mathrm{id}_C .$$

Similarly,

$$(b \circ a) \circ g = b \circ (a \circ g) = b \circ \pi = g,$$

and also

$$\mathrm{id}_H \circ g = g.$$

Since $g : N \to H$ is a cokernel of f, the uniqueness part of its universal property implies

$$b \circ a = \mathrm{id}_H .$$

Therefore a and b are inverse isomorphisms, and hence

$$H \cong C = \big(N_i/f_i(M_i),\ \overline{\psi}_\alpha\big).$$

In particular, for each vertex i we have

$$H_i \cong N_i/f_i(M_i),$$

and under these identifications, for every arrow $\alpha : i \to j$,

$$\chi_\alpha = a_j^{-1} \circ \overline{\psi}_\alpha \circ a_i.$$

Thus any cokernel given by the universal property is isomorphic to the pointwise quotient representation

$$\big(N_i/f_i(M_i),\ \psi_\alpha \text{ induced on the quotients}\big).$$

$\square$

Theorem 3.2.4 (the first isomorphism theorem)**.** *If $f : M \to N$ is a morphism of representations, then* $\operatorname{im} f \cong M/\ker f$.

Proof. Write

$$M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha), \qquad N = (N_i, \psi_\alpha).$$

Then

$$\operatorname{im} f = (\operatorname{im} f_i, \psi_\alpha|_{\operatorname{im} f_i}).$$

This is a representation, since for every arrow $\alpha : i \to j$ and every $m_i \in M_i$,

$$\psi_\alpha(f_i(m_i)) = f_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) \in \operatorname{im} f_j.$$

Also,

$$M/\ker f = \big(M_i/\ker f_i, \overline{\varphi}_\alpha\big),$$

where for $\alpha : i \to j$,

$$\overline{\varphi}_\alpha(m_i + \ker f_i) = \varphi_\alpha(m_i) + \ker f_j.$$

For each vertex i, the first isomorphism theorem for vector spaces gives an isomorphism

$$\overline{f}_i : M_i/\ker f_i \longrightarrow \operatorname{im} f_i, \qquad \overline{f}_i(m_i + \ker f_i) = f_i(m_i).$$

We claim that $\overline{f} = (\overline{f}_i)$ is a morphism of representations. Consider the diagram

$$\begin{tikzcd} M_i/\ker f_i \arrow[r, "\overline{\varphi}_\alpha"] \arrow[d, "\overline{f}_i"'] & M_j/\ker f_j \arrow[d, "\overline{f}_j"] \\ \operatorname{im} f_i \arrow[r, "\psi_\alpha|_{\operatorname{im} f_i}"] & \operatorname{im} f_j \end{tikzcd}$$

For any $m_i \in M_i$,

$$\begin{aligned} \overline{f}_j\big(\overline{\varphi}_\alpha(m_i + \ker f_i)\big) &= \overline{f}_j\big(\varphi_\alpha(m_i) + \ker f_j\big) \\ &= f_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) = \psi_\alpha(f_i(m_i)) \\ &= \psi_\alpha|_{\operatorname{im} f_i}\big(\overline{f}_i(m_i + \ker f_i)\big). \end{aligned}$$

Hence the diagram commutes for every arrow α, so $\overline{f} : M/\ker f \to \operatorname{im} f$ is a morphism in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$. Since each $\overline{f}_i$ is an isomorphism, $\overline{f}$ is an isomorphism of representations. Therefore

$$M/\ker f \cong \operatorname{im} f.$$

□

These all together shows that $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ is an abelian category.

Definition 3.2.5. *We call a category $\mathcal{C}$ abelian k-category if the following conditions are satisfied:*

1. *$\mathcal{C}$ is k-category, for any $X, Y \in \operatorname{Ob}(\mathcal{C})$, $\operatorname{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y)$ is a vector space over k.*
2. *$\mathcal{C}$ is a additive category, $\mathcal{C}$ has direct sums and zero object.*
3. *Each morphism $f : X \to Y$ has kernel K and cokernel H. $f : M \to N$, $i : K \to M$, $p : N \to H$. and $\operatorname{coker} i \cong \ker p$.*

3.3 Exact and Split Exact Sequences

Definition 3.3.1. *Let* $M \xrightarrow{f} N \xrightarrow{p} P$ *be a sequence of morphisms in* $\operatorname{Rep} Q$*. We say that this sequence is exact (at* N*) if* $\ker p = \operatorname{im} f$*.*

Definition 3.3.2. *We call a sequence of morphisms in* $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ *a short exact sequence if it is exact and of the form*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

Where f *is injective,* g *is surjective,* $\operatorname{im} f = \ker g$

For $f : M \to N$ we have exact sequence:

$$0 \longrightarrow \ker f \xrightarrow{i} M \xrightarrow{f} N \xrightarrow{p} \operatorname{coker} f \longrightarrow 0$$

Where i is an inclusion and p is a projection.

Or we have short exact sequence:

$$0 \longrightarrow \ker f \xrightarrow{i} M \xrightarrow{p} M/\ker f \longrightarrow 0$$

Example 3.3.3. *The quiver is given by:*

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

Consider the following representations:

- S_1*:* $k \xrightarrow{0} 0$
- S_2*:* $0 \xrightarrow{0} k$
- M*:* $k \xrightarrow{1} k$

Exact Sequences: *The following short exact sequences are presented:*

$$0 \longrightarrow S_2 \xrightarrow{(0,1)} M \xrightarrow{(1,0)} S_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

$$0 \longrightarrow S_2 \xrightarrow{(0,1)} S_1 \oplus S_2 \xrightarrow{(1,0)} S_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

Both sequences are exact.

Definition 3.3.4. *A morphism* $f : L \to M$ *is a section if there exists a morphism* $h : M \to L$ *such that* $hf = 1_L$*. A morphism* $g : M \to N$ *is a retraction if there exists a morphism* $h : N \to M$ *such that* $gh = 1_N$*.*

Definition 3.3.5. *We say that a short exact sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

splits if f has a retraction or equivalently f is a section.

Example 3.3.6. *In the example before, the second sequence splits.*
Take the first short exact sequence: the middle term is the direct sum $S_1 \oplus S_2$, *with*

$$f = (0,1) \text{ (inclusion of the second summand)}, g = (1,0) \text{ (projection onto the first)}.$$

Take the projection $h\colon S_1 \oplus S_2 \to S_2$ onto the second factor (at each vertex). Then

$$(hf)(s_2) = h(0, s_2) = s_2 \quad \forall s_2 \in S_2, \qquad \text{so } hf = 1_{S_2}.$$

Thus f has a retraction and the sequence splits. Equivalently, the inclusion $h'\colon S_1 \to S_1 \oplus S_2$ of the first summand satisfies $gh' = 1_{S_1}$, so g has a section.
By contrast, take the second short exact sequence: the middle term here is M, the representation

$$k \xrightarrow{1} k,$$

which is indecomposable and not isomorphic to $S_1 \oplus S_2$. There is no morphism from M to S_2 giving a retraction of f, so the first sequence does not split.

Chapter 4

Lecture 4

4.1 Split Exact Sequences

Recall short exact sequence:

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

Where $\ker f = L$, $\operatorname{im} f = \ker g$, $\operatorname{im} g = N$.

f is section if $\exists h : M \to L$ such that $hf = 1_L$. g is retraction if $\exists h' : N \to M$ such that $gh' = 1_N$.

Theorem 4.1.1. *Taking a short exact sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

1. *f is a section if and only if g is a retraction.*
2. *If f is a section then $\ker g = \operatorname{im} f$ is a direct summand of M.*

proof of (a). ($\Rightarrow$): Suppose f is a section. $\exists h : M \to L$ such that $hf = 1_L$. We will define $h' : N \to M$ and show that $gh' = 1_N$. $\forall n \in N$, since g is surjective $\exists m$ such that $n = g(m)$. $h'(n) = m - f(h(m))$ where $h' : N \to M$. We have to show that h' is well-defined. Suppose m, m' such that $n = g(m) = g(m')$. We have to show that $m' - f(h(m')) = m - f(h(m))$.

Since $g(m) - g(m') = g(m - m') = 0$, $m - m' \in \ker g = \operatorname{im} f$, $\exists l \in L$ such that $f(l) = m - m'$. Hence $m - m' = f(l) = f(hf)(l) = f(h(m) - h(m')) = f(h(m)) - f(h(m'))$. Hence $m' - f(h(m')) = m - f(h(m))$.

We need to show h' is a morphism. Let $M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha), L = (L_i, \varphi'_\alpha), N = (N_i, \varphi''_\alpha)$. Then f, g, h are morphisms of representations. We have to show that h' is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : i \to j$ be an arrow in Q. Then consider the following diagram:

$$\begin{tikzcd}
\overset{L_i}{\bullet} \arrow[r, "\varphi'_\alpha"] \arrow[d, shift right, "f_i"'] & \overset{L_j}{\bullet} \arrow[d, shift left, "f_j"] \\
\overset{M_i}{\bullet} \arrow[r, "\varphi_\alpha"] \arrow[u, shift right, "h_i"'] \arrow[d, shift right, "g_i"'] & \overset{M_j}{\bullet} \arrow[u, shift left, "h_j"] \arrow[d, shift left, "g_j"] \\
\overset{N_i}{\bullet} \arrow[r, "\varphi''_\alpha"] \arrow[u, shift right, "h'_i"'] & \overset{N_j}{\bullet} \arrow[u, shift left, "h'_j"]
\end{tikzcd}$$

Take $n_i \in N_i$, and for n_i we choose m_i such that $g_i(m_i) = n_i, h'_i(n_i) = m_i - f_i(h_i(m_i))$. Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}
\varphi_\alpha h'_i(n_i) &= \varphi_\alpha(m_i - f_i(h_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - \varphi_\alpha(f_i(h_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - f_j(\varphi'_\alpha(h_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)))
\end{aligned}$$

And

$$\begin{aligned}
h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(n_i)) &= h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(g_i(m_i))) \\
&= h'_j(g_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i))) \\
&\text{(define } n_j = g_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i))\text{)} \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)))
\end{aligned}$$

Hence h' is a morphism of representations.

The only thing need to show now is that $gh' = 1_N$. Let $n_i \in N_i$, then $\exists m_i \in M_i$ such that $n_i = g_i(m_i)$. Then $g_i(h'_i(n_i)) = g_i(m_i - f_i(h_i(m_i))) = g_i(m_i) - g_i(f_i(h_i(m_i))) = g_i(m_i) = n_i$. Hence $gh' = 1_N$. (Since $f_i(h_i(m_i)) \in \operatorname{im} f_i = \ker g_i$).

($\Leftarrow$): Suppose g is a retraction. $\exists h' : N \to M$ such that $gh' = 1_N$. We will define $h : M \to L$ and show that $hf = 1_L$.

For any m we have $g(m - h'g(m)) = g(m) - g(h'g(m)) = g(m) - g(m) = 0$. Hence $m - h'g(m) \in \ker g = \operatorname{im} f$. Hence $\exists! l \in L$ such that $f(l) = m - h'g(m)$ since f is injective. Define $h(m) = l$.

We have to show that h is a morphism of representations. Let $M = (M_i, \varphi_\alpha), L = (L_i, \varphi'_\alpha), N = (N_i, \varphi''_\alpha)$. Then f, g, h' are morphisms of representations. We have to show that h is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : i \to j$ be an arrow in Q. Then consider the following diagram:

$$\begin{tikzcd}
L_i \arrow[r, "\varphi'_\alpha"] \arrow[d, shift right, "f_i"'] & L_j \arrow[d, shift left, "f_j"] \\
M_i \arrow[r, "\varphi_\alpha"] \arrow[u, shift right, "h_i"'] \arrow[d, shift right, "g_i"'] & M_j \arrow[u, shift left, "h_j"] \arrow[d, shift left, "g_j"] \\
N_i \arrow[r, "\varphi''_\alpha"] \arrow[u, shift right, "h'_i"'] & NN_j \arrow[u, shift left, "h'_j"]
\end{tikzcd}$$

Take $m_i \in M_i$, and for m_i we choose $l_i \in L_i$ such that $f_i(l_i) = m_i - h'_i g_i(m_i)$ and $h_i(m_i) = l_i$. Then we have

$$\varphi'_\alpha(h_i(m_i)) = \varphi'_\alpha(l_i)$$

On the other hand,

$$\begin{aligned}
f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i))) &= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - h'_j g_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(g_i(m_i))) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i) - \varphi_\alpha(h'_i g_i(m_i)) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(m_i - h'_i g_i(m_i)) \\
&= \varphi_\alpha(f_i(l_i)) \\
&= f_j(\varphi'_\alpha(l_i))
\end{aligned}$$

Hence $f_j(h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i))) = f_j(\varphi'_\alpha(l_i))$. Since f_j is injective, $h_j(\varphi_\alpha(m_i)) = \varphi'_\alpha(l_i)$. Hence h is a morphism of representations. □

proof of (b). Suppose f is a section then g is a retraction. $\forall m \in M$, $\exists h : M \to L$ such that $hf = 1_L$ and $\exists h' : N \to M$ such that $gh' = 1_N$. Then $m = h'g(m) + (m - h'g(m))$ where $h'g(m) \in \operatorname{im} h'$ and $m - h'g(m) \in \ker g$. And $\operatorname{im} h' \cap \ker g = 0$. Thus $M_i = \ker g \oplus \operatorname{im} h'$ as vector spaces.

Furthermore we need to show that $\ker g \oplus \operatorname{im} h'$ is a direct sum of representations. i.e.

$$\varphi_\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} \varphi_\alpha|_{\ker g_i} & 0 \\ 0 & \varphi_\alpha|_{\operatorname{im} h'_i} \end{bmatrix}$$

Let $m_i \in \ker g_i$, then $0 = \varphi''_\alpha(g_i(m_i)) = g_j \varphi'_\alpha(m_i)$ where $\varphi'_\alpha(m_i) \in \ker g_j$ and hence the upper right block of the matrix is zero.

If $m_i \in \operatorname{im} h'_i$, and therefore

$$\varphi_\alpha(m_i) = \varphi_\alpha(h'_i(n_i)) = h'_j(\varphi''_\alpha(n_i))$$

is an element of $\operatorname{im} h'_j$. This shows that the lower left block of the matrix is zero and hence φ_α is a block diagonal matrix. □

Corollary 4.1.2. *If*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is a short exact split sequence in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$*, then* $M = L \oplus N$ *as representations.*

Proof. f is injective, $L \cong \operatorname{im} f = \ker g$. By isomorphism theorem $M/\ker g \cong N$. Since g is surjective, $N \cong \operatorname{im} g$. Statement follows from (b) of the previous theorem. $\square$

4.2 Hom Functor

Definition 4.2.1. *Let* $\mathcal{C}$ *and* $\mathcal{C}'$ *be two categories. A* ***covariant functor*** $F : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{C}'$ *is a map that assigns to each object* $X \in \mathcal{C}$ *an object* $F(X) \in \mathcal{C}'$ *and to each morphism* $f : X \to Y$ *in* $\mathcal{C}$ *a morphism* $F(f) : F(X) \to F(Y)$ *in* $\mathcal{C}'$*, satisfying the following conditions:*

- $F(f \circ g) = F(f) \circ F(g)$ *for all morphisms* $f : X \to Y$ *and* $g : Y \to Z$ *in* $\mathcal{C}$.
- $F(\mathrm{id}_X) = \mathrm{id}_{F(X)}$ *for all objects* $X \in \mathcal{C}$.

If $F(f \circ g) = F(g) \circ F(f)$ *for all morphisms* $f : X \to Y$ *and* $g : Y \to Z$ *in* $\mathcal{C}$*, then* F *is called a* ***contravariant functor****.*

If $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$ then $\operatorname{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, -)$ is a covariant functor from $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ to the category of k-vector spaces where $\operatorname{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(-, X)$ is a contravariant functor from $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ to the category of k-vector spaces.

Example 4.2.2. *Fix* $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$*. Let* $M, N \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$*. Then* $\operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(X, M)$ *is a* k*-vector space. For a morphism* $f : M \to N$*, define*

$$\operatorname{Hom}(X, f) := f_* : \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(X, M) \to \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(X, N), \qquad f_*(g) = f \circ g.$$

This is a k*-linear map. This map* f_* *is called the* ***pushforward*** *of* f*. For* $g \in \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(X, M)$*, the image* $f_*(g) = f \circ g$ *is the composite in* $\operatorname{Rep} Q$*; the following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} X \arrow[r, "g"] \arrow[rr, bend right, "f_*(g)=f\circ g"'] & M \arrow[r, "f"] & N \end{tikzcd}$$

Example 4.2.3. *Fix* $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$*. Let* $M, N \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$*. Then* $\operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(M, X)$ *and* $\operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(N, X)$ *are* k*-vector spaces. For a morphism* $f : M \to N$*, define*

$$\operatorname{Hom}(f, X) := f^* : \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(N, X) \to \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep} Q}(M, X), \qquad f^*(g) = g \circ f.$$

This is a k*-linear map. This map* f^* *is called the* ***pullback*** *of* f*. For* $g \in$

$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Rep}\,Q}(N, X)$, *the image* $f^*(g) = g \circ f$ *is the composite in* $\mathrm{Rep}\,Q$*; the following diagram commutes:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} M \arrow[r, "f"] \arrow[rr, bend right, "f^*(g)=g\circ f"'] & N \arrow[r, "g"] & X \end{tikzcd}$$

Chapter 5

Lecture 5

5.1 Hom Functor Acts on Exact Sequences

Theorem 5.1.1. *Let Q be a quiver.*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

a sequence of representations in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$*. Then this sequence is exact if and only if for every* $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$*, the sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(X,f)} \operatorname{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(X,g)} \operatorname{Hom}(X, N)$$

is exact.

Proof. Assume first that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$. We show that for every $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$, the induced sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(X,f)} \operatorname{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(X,g)} \operatorname{Hom}(X, N)$$

is exact.

Since f is a monomorphism, if $u, v \in \operatorname{Hom}(X, L)$ satisfy

$$\operatorname{Hom}(X, f)(u) = \operatorname{Hom}(X, f)(v),$$

then $f \circ u = f \circ v$, hence $u = v$. Therefore $\operatorname{Hom}(X, f)$ is injective.

Next, since $g \circ f = 0$, we have

$$\operatorname{Hom}(X, g) \circ \operatorname{Hom}(X, f) = \operatorname{Hom}(X, g \circ f) = 0,$$

so

$$\operatorname{im} \operatorname{Hom}(X, f) \subseteq \ker \operatorname{Hom}(X, g).$$

Conversely, let $h \in \mathrm{Hom}(X, M)$ satisfy $\mathrm{Hom}(X, g)(h) = 0$, that is, $g \circ h = 0$. Since the original sequence is exact, $f : L \to M$ is the kernel of g. Hence, by the universal property of the kernel, there exists a unique morphism $u : X \to L$ such that

$$f \circ u = h.$$

Thus $h = \mathrm{Hom}(X, f)(u)$, so

$$\ker \mathrm{Hom}(X, g) \subseteq \operatorname{im} \mathrm{Hom}(X, f).$$

Therefore

$$\ker \mathrm{Hom}(X, g) = \operatorname{im} \mathrm{Hom}(X, f),$$

and the induced sequence is exact.

Conversely, assume that for every $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Hom}(X,f)} \mathrm{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Hom}(X,g)} \mathrm{Hom}(X, N)$$

is exact. We prove that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact.

We first show that $g \circ f = 0$. Take $X = L$. Since

$$\mathrm{Hom}(L, g) \circ \mathrm{Hom}(L, f) = 0,$$

evaluating at $1_L \in \mathrm{Hom}(L, L)$ gives

$$g \circ f = 0.$$

Next we show that f is a monomorphism. Let $K = \ker f$, and let

$$\iota : K \to L$$

be the kernel morphism. Then

$$f \circ \iota = 0,$$

so

$$\mathrm{Hom}(K, f)(\iota) = 0.$$

By assumption, the map

$$\mathrm{Hom}(K, f) : \mathrm{Hom}(K, L) \to \mathrm{Hom}(K, M)$$

is injective, hence $\iota = 0$. Therefore $K = 0$, so f is a monomorphism.

Finally, we show that $\ker g = \operatorname{im} f$. Let $K = \ker g$, with kernel morphism

$$\kappa : K \to M.$$

Since $g \circ \kappa = 0$, we have

$$\mathrm{Hom}(K, g)(\kappa) = 0.$$

By the exactness of

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(K, L) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Hom}(K,f)} \mathrm{Hom}(K, M) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Hom}(K,g)} \mathrm{Hom}(K, N),$$

there exists a morphism $u : K \to L$ such that

$$\mathrm{Hom}(K, f)(u) = \kappa,$$

that is,

$$f \circ u = \kappa.$$

Thus κ factors through f, which implies

$$\ker g \subseteq \mathrm{im}\, f.$$

On the other hand, since $g \circ f = 0$, we have

$$\mathrm{im}\, f \subseteq \ker g.$$

Hence

$$\ker g = \mathrm{im}\, f.$$

Therefore the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact. □

Similarly we have the following theorem:

Theorem 5.1.2. *Let Q be a quiver.*

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

a sequence of representations in $\mathrm{Rep}\, Q$*. Then this sequence is exact if and only if for every $X \in \mathrm{Rep}\, Q$, the sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(N, X) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Hom}(f,X)} \mathrm{Hom}(M, X) \xrightarrow{\mathrm{Hom}(g,X)} \mathrm{Hom}(L, X)$$

is exact.

Proof. Assume first that

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$. We show that for every $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$, the induced sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(N, X) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(f,X)} \operatorname{Hom}(M, X) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(g,X)} \operatorname{Hom}(L, X)$$

is exact.

Since f is an epimorphism, if $u, v \in \operatorname{Hom}(N, X)$ satisfy

$$\operatorname{Hom}(f, X)(u) = \operatorname{Hom}(f, X)(v),$$

then $u \circ f = v \circ f$, hence $u = v$. Therefore $\operatorname{Hom}(f, X)$ is injective.

Next, since $f \circ g = 0$, we have

$$\operatorname{Hom}(g, X) \circ \operatorname{Hom}(f, X) = \operatorname{Hom}(f \circ g, X) = 0,$$

so

$$\operatorname{im} \operatorname{Hom}(f, X) \subseteq \ker \operatorname{Hom}(g, X).$$

Conversely, let $h \in \operatorname{Hom}(M, X)$ satisfy $\operatorname{Hom}(g, X)(h) = 0$, that is, $h \circ g = 0$. Since the original sequence is exact, $f : M \to N$ is the cokernel of g. Hence, by the universal property of the cokernel, there exists a unique morphism $u : N \to X$ such that

$$u \circ f = h.$$

Thus $h = \operatorname{Hom}(f, X)(u)$, so

$$\ker \operatorname{Hom}(g, X) \subseteq \operatorname{im} \operatorname{Hom}(f, X).$$

Therefore

$$\ker \operatorname{Hom}(g, X) = \operatorname{im} \operatorname{Hom}(f, X),$$

and the induced sequence is exact.

Conversely, assume that for every $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(N, X) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(f,X)} \operatorname{Hom}(M, X) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(g,X)} \operatorname{Hom}(L, X)$$

is exact. We prove that

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

We first show that $f \circ g = 0$. Take $X = N$. Since

$$\operatorname{Hom}(g, N) \circ \operatorname{Hom}(f, N) = 0,$$

evaluating at $1_N \in \operatorname{Hom}(N, N)$ gives

$$f \circ g = 0.$$

Next we show that f is an epimorphism. Let $C = \operatorname{coker} f$, and let

$$\pi : N \to C$$

be the cokernel morphism. Then

$$\pi \circ f = 0,$$

so

$$\operatorname{Hom}(f, C)(\pi) = 0.$$

By assumption, the map

$$\operatorname{Hom}(f, C) : \operatorname{Hom}(N, C) \to \operatorname{Hom}(M, C)$$

is injective, hence $\pi = 0$. Therefore $C = 0$, so f is an epimorphism.

Finally, we show that $\ker f = \operatorname{im} g$. Let $C = \operatorname{coker} g$, with cokernel morphism

$$\gamma : M \to C.$$

Since $\gamma \circ g = 0$, we have

$$\operatorname{Hom}(g, C)(\gamma) = 0.$$

By the exactness of

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(N, C) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(f,C)} \operatorname{Hom}(M, C) \xrightarrow{\operatorname{Hom}(g,C)} \operatorname{Hom}(L, C),$$

there exists a morphism $u : N \to C$ such that

$$\operatorname{Hom}(f, C)(u) = \gamma,$$

that is,

$$u \circ f = \gamma.$$

Thus γ factors through f, which implies

$$\ker f \subseteq \operatorname{im} g.$$

On the other hand, since $f \circ g = 0$, we have

$$\operatorname{im} g \subseteq \ker f.$$

Hence

$$\ker f = \operatorname{im} g.$$

Therefore the sequence

$$L \xrightarrow{g} M \xrightarrow{f} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact. $\square$

Corollary 5.1.3. *Let*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

be a sequence in $\operatorname{rep} Q$. *Then the sequence is split exact if and only if, for every* $X \in \operatorname{rep} Q$, *the sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{f_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{g_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, N) \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

Proof. Assume first that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is split exact. By Theorem above, it is enough to show that

$$g_* : \operatorname{Hom}(X, M) \to \operatorname{Hom}(X, N)$$

is surjective for every $X \in \operatorname{rep} Q$.

Since the sequence is split exact, the morphism g is a retraction. Hence there exists

$$h \in \operatorname{Hom}(N, M)$$

such that

$$gh = 1_N.$$

Now let $u \in \operatorname{Hom}(X, N)$. Then $hu \in \operatorname{Hom}(X, M)$, and

$$g_*(hu) = g \circ h \circ u = 1_N \circ u = u.$$

Thus every element of $\operatorname{Hom}(X, N)$ lies in the image of g_*, so g_* is surjective. Therefore

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{f_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{g_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, N) \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

Conversely, suppose that for every $X \in \operatorname{rep} Q$, the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{f_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{g_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, N) \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact.

By Theorem above, it follows that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact. It remains to show that this exact sequence splits.

Take $X = N$. Since

$$g_* : \mathrm{Hom}(N, M) \to \mathrm{Hom}(N, N)$$

is surjective, there exists

$$h \in \mathrm{Hom}(N, M)$$

such that

$$g_*(h) = 1_N.$$

By definition of g_*, this means

$$g \circ h = 1_N.$$

Hence g is a retraction, and therefore the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is split exact. □

Example 5.1.4. *Let Q be the quiver*

$$1 \longrightarrow 2$$

Consider S_1, S_2, M defined as before.

$$S_1 : \ k \longrightarrow 0$$

$$S_2 : \ 0 \longrightarrow k$$

$$M : \ k \xrightarrow{1} k$$

We have the following sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow S_2 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow S_1 \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact. But non-split.
Now consider the Hom functor $\mathrm{Hom}(S_1, -)$. Apply to this sequence, we get the following sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(S_1, S_2) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(S_1, M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(S_1, S_1) \longrightarrow 0$$

Then $\mathrm{Hom}(S_1, S_2) = \mathrm{Hom}(S_1, M) = 0$ and $\mathrm{Hom}(S_1, S_1) = k$. Therefore the "Hom-sequence" can never be exact.

Chapter 6

Lecture 6

6.1 First Examples of Auslander–Reiten Quivers

The goal of the representation theory of a quiver Q is to understand the representations in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$, the morphisms between them, and, more generally, the short exact sequences in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$.

A first approximation to this structure is given by the *Auslander–Reiten quiver*. In the representation-finite case, it encodes all indecomposable representations, the irreducible morphisms between them, and the basic non-split short exact sequences, i.e. almost split sequences.

Definition 6.1.1 (Almost split sequence)**.** *Let A be a finite-dimensional algebra, and let*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

be a short exact sequence in $\operatorname{mod} A$ *(the A-module category). We say that this sequence is an* almost split sequence *(or an* Auslander–Reiten sequence*) if*

- *f is a left minimal almost split morphism, and*
- *g is a right minimal almost split morphism.*

Definition 6.1.2 (Left minimal almost split morphism)**.** *A morphism $f\colon L \to M$ in* $\operatorname{mod} A$ *is called* left minimal almost split *if the following conditions hold:*

1. *f is not a section;*
2. *for every morphism $u\colon L \to U$ which is not a section, there exists a morphism $u'\colon M \to U$ such that*
$$u'f = u;$$
3. *for every endomorphism $h\colon M \to M$ satisfying*
$$hf = f,$$

the morphism h is an isomorphism.

Definition 6.1.3 (Right minimal almost split morphism). *A morphism $g\colon M \to N$ in* $\operatorname{mod} A$ *is called* right minimal almost split *if the following conditions hold:*

1. *g is not a retraction;*
2. *for every morphism $v\colon V \to N$ which is not a retraction, there exists a morphism $v'\colon V \to M$ such that*
$$gv' = v;$$
3. *for every endomorphism $h\colon M \to M$ satisfying*
$$gh = g,$$
the morphism h is an isomorphism.

In this section we present only the first examples. A systematic treatment will be given later.

Let Q be a quiver. The *Auslander–Reiten quiver* Γ_Q is a quiver defined as follows.

- Its vertices are the isomorphism classes of indecomposable representations of Q.
- Its arrows correspond to *irreducible morphisms* between indecomposable representations.

Very roughly, an irreducible morphism is a morphism between indecomposable representations that does not factor in a nontrivial way through another representation.

Thus:

- indecomposable representations are the building blocks of all representations;
- irreducible morphisms are the basic building blocks of many morphisms;
- almost split sequences appear in the Auslander–Reiten quiver in the form of *meshes*.

We now look at the first examples.

Let
$$Q: \quad 1 \longrightarrow 2.$$

Up to isomorphism, there are exactly three indecomposable representations:

$$S(2) = (0 \longrightarrow k)\,, \qquad M = \left(k \xrightarrow{1} k\right), \qquad S(1) = (k \longrightarrow 0)\,.$$

From direct computations of Hom-spaces, one finds:

$$\operatorname{Hom}(S(1), M) = 0, \qquad \operatorname{Hom}(M, S(2)) = 0, \qquad \operatorname{Hom}(S(2), M) \cong k,$$

$$\operatorname{Hom}(S(1),S(2))=0,\qquad \operatorname{Hom}(M,S(1))\cong k,\qquad \operatorname{Hom}(S(2),S(1))=0.$$

Hence there is exactly one non-split short exact sequence with indecomposable end terms:

$$0\longrightarrow S(2)\longrightarrow M\longrightarrow S(1)\longrightarrow 0.$$

This sequence is an almost split sequence. Therefore the Auslander–Reiten quiver has three vertices, two arrows, and one mesh:

$$\begin{tikzcd} & M \arrow[dr] & \\ S(2) \arrow[ur] & & S(1) \end{tikzcd}$$

It is often useful to encode an indecomposable representation by its dimension vector together with the relative position of the vertices.

Suppose

$$Q_0=\{1,2,\dots,n\},\qquad M=(M_i,\varphi_\alpha)$$

is an indecomposable representation of Q, and

$$\dim M=(d_1,d_2,\dots,d_n).$$

We depict M by writing the digit i exactly d_i times. Moreover, if there is an arrow $\alpha : i\to j$ such that the map

$$\varphi_\alpha : M_i\to M_j$$

is nonzero, then we place the symbol i above the symbol j.

For the quiver $1\to 2$, the representation

$$M=\left(k\xrightarrow{1}k\right)$$

may be represented symbolically by

$$\begin{smallmatrix}1\\2\end{smallmatrix},$$

meaning that both vector spaces are one-dimensional and the arrow carries a nonzero map.

In this notation, the Auslander–Reiten quiver above becomes

$$\begin{tikzcd} & \begin{smallmatrix}1\\2\end{smallmatrix} \arrow[dr] & \\ 2 \arrow[ur] & & 1 \end{tikzcd}$$

Let

$$Q:\quad 1\longrightarrow 2\longleftarrow 3.$$

In this case there are exactly six isomorphism classes of indecomposable representations:

$$S(2)=(0\longrightarrow k\longleftarrow 0)\,,\qquad P(1)=\left(k\xrightarrow{1}k\longleftarrow 0\right),\qquad P(3)=\left(0\longrightarrow k\xleftarrow{1}k\right),$$

$$I(2) = \left(k \xrightarrow{1} k \xleftarrow{1} k\right), \qquad S(1) = (k \longrightarrow 0 \longleftarrow 0), \qquad S(3) = (0 \longrightarrow 0 \longleftarrow k).$$

Using the symbolic notation, these are

$$S(2) = 2, \qquad P(1) = \substack{1\\2}, \qquad P(3) = \substack{3\\2}, \qquad I(2) = \substack{13\\2}, \qquad S(1) = 1, \qquad S(3) = 3.$$

There are three almost split sequences:

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \substack{1\\2} \oplus \substack{3\\2} \longrightarrow \substack{13\\2} \longrightarrow 0,$$

$$0 \longrightarrow \substack{1\\2} \longrightarrow \substack{13\\2} \longrightarrow 3 \longrightarrow 0,$$

$$0 \longrightarrow \substack{3\\2} \longrightarrow \substack{13\\2} \longrightarrow 1 \longrightarrow 0.$$

Consequently, the Auslander–Reiten quiver has the form

$$\begin{tikzcd}
 & \substack{3\\2} \arrow[dr] & & 1 \\
2 \arrow[ur] \arrow[dr] & & \substack{13\\2} \arrow[ur] \arrow[dr] & \\
 & \substack{1\\2} \arrow[ur] & & 3
\end{tikzcd}$$

In the quiver $1 \to 2 \leftarrow 3$, besides the almost split sequences above, there are also two further non-split short exact sequences with indecomposable end terms:

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \substack{3\\2} \longrightarrow 3 \longrightarrow 0,$$

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \substack{1\\2} \longrightarrow 1 \longrightarrow 0.$$

These are not themselves almost split sequences, but they may be viewed as being obtained by combining meshes in the Auslander–Reiten quiver.

These examples illustrate the philosophy of Auslander–Reiten theory:

- vertices correspond to indecomposable representations;
- arrows correspond to irreducible morphisms;
- meshes encode almost split sequences.

Thus the Auslander–Reiten quiver provides a compact and highly structured picture of the category $\operatorname{Rep} Q$.

6.2 Simple, Projective and Injective in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$

Definition 6.2.1. *Let Q be a quiver without oriented cycles. $Q = (Q_0, Q_1, s, t)$. We say that $C = (i|\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_j|j)$ is a path from i to j if $s(\alpha_1) = i$ and $t(\alpha_j) = j$, $s(\alpha_{i+1}) = t(\alpha_i)$ for $i = 1, \ldots, j-1$ as*

$$i \xrightarrow{\alpha_1} \ldots \xrightarrow{\alpha_j} j$$

Example 6.2.2. *Consider:*

$$\begin{tikzcd} 1 \arrow[loop left, "\alpha"] \arrow[r, "\beta"] & 2 \arrow[r, "\gamma"] & 3 \end{tikzcd}$$

Then $(1|\alpha, \beta, \gamma|2)$ is not a path.

Definition 6.2.3 (Oriented cycle)**.** *Let $Q = (Q_0, Q_1, s, t)$ be a quiver. An* oriented cycle *in Q is a path*

$$c = (i \mid \alpha_1, \alpha_2, \ldots, \alpha_\ell \mid i)$$

of length $\ell \geq 1$ such that

$$s(\alpha_1) = i, \qquad s(\alpha_{r+1}) = t(\alpha_r) \text{ for } r = 1, \ldots, \ell - 1, \qquad t(\alpha_\ell) = i.$$

In other words, it is a path which starts at a vertex i, follows the directions of the arrows, and ends again at the same vertex i.
In particular, a loop

$$\begin{tikzcd} i \arrow[loop above, "\alpha"] \end{tikzcd}$$

is an oriented cycle of length 1.

Definition 6.2.4. *We call $(i|i)$ a constant path or a lazy path.*

Let Q be a quiver without oriented cycles.

Definition 6.2.5. *Let i be a vertex of Q. Define representations $S(i)$ as follows: $S(i)$ is of dimension one at vertex i and zero at every other vertex; thus*

$$S(i) = \big(S(i)_j, \varphi_\alpha\big)_{j \in Q_0, \alpha \in Q_1},$$

where

$$S(i)_j = \begin{cases} k & \text{if } i = j, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \qquad \text{and} \qquad \varphi_\alpha = 0 \quad \text{for all arrows } \alpha.$$

$S(i)$ is called the simple representation *at vertex i.*

Definition 6.2.6. *Let i be a vertex of Q. Define representations $P(i)$ as follows:*

$$P(i) = \big(P(i)_j, \varphi_\alpha\big)_{j\in Q_0, \alpha\in Q_1}$$

$P(i)_j$ is the k-vector space with basis the set of all paths from i to j in Q; so the elements of $P(i)_j$ are of the form $\sum_c \lambda_c c$, where c runs over all paths from i to j, and $\lambda_c \in k$;
and if $j \xrightarrow{\alpha} \ell$ is an arrow in Q, then

$$\varphi_\alpha : P(i)_j \longrightarrow P(i)_\ell$$

is the linear map defined on the basis by composing the paths from i to j with the arrow

$$j \xrightarrow{\alpha} \ell.$$

More precisely, the arrow α induces an injective map between the bases

$$\text{basis of } P(i)_j \longrightarrow \text{basis of } P(i)_\ell$$

$$c = (i \mid \beta_1, \beta_2, \dots, \beta_s \mid j) \longmapsto \alpha c = (i \mid \beta_1, \beta_2, \dots, \beta_s, \alpha \mid \ell)$$

and φ_α is defined by

$$\varphi_\alpha\left(\sum_c \lambda_c\, c\right) = \sum_c \lambda_c\, \alpha c.$$

$P(i)$ is called the projective representation *at vertex i.*

Example 6.2.7. *Consider the quiver:*

$$1 \xrightarrow{\alpha} 2 \xleftarrow{\beta} 3$$

We construct $P(1)$. First, $P(1)_1 = k$. Now we have one path $(1|\alpha|2)$. So $P(1)_2 = k$. Then $\psi_\alpha = [a], a \in \mathbb{F}^\times$ a 1 by 1 invertible matrix. We have no path from 1 to 3. So $P(1)_3 = 0$. Thus

$$P(1) = \ k \xrightarrow{1} k \longleftarrow 0$$

Definition 6.2.8. *Let i be a vertex of Q. Define representations $I(i)$ as follows:*

$$I(i) = \big(I(i)_j, \varphi_\alpha\big)_{j\in Q_0, \alpha\in Q_1}$$

where $I(i)_j$ is the k-vector space with basis the set of all paths from j to i in Q; so the elements of $I(i)_j$ are of the form $\sum_c \lambda_c c$, where c runs over all paths from j to i, and $\lambda_c \in k$;

and if $j \xrightarrow{\alpha} \ell$ *is an arrow in* Q, *then*

$$\varphi_\alpha : I(i)_j \to I(i)_\ell$$

is the linear map defined on the basis by deleting the arrow

$$j \xrightarrow{\alpha} \ell$$

from those paths from j *to* i *which start with* α *and sending to zero the paths that do not start with* α.

More precisely, the arrow α *induces a surjective map* f *between the bases*

$$\text{basis of } I(i)_j \xrightarrow{f} \text{basis of } I(i)_\ell$$

$$c = (j \mid \beta_1, \beta_2, \ldots, \beta_s \mid i) \longmapsto \begin{cases} (\ell \mid \beta_2, \ldots, \beta_s \mid i) & \text{if } \beta_1 = \alpha, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise;} \end{cases}$$

and φ_α *is defined by*

$$\varphi_\alpha\left(\sum_c \lambda_c\, c\right) = \sum_c \lambda_c\, f(c).$$

$I(i)$ *is called the* injective representation *at vertex* i.

Example 6.2.9. *Take the quiver:*

$$1 \xrightarrow{\alpha} 2 \xleftarrow{\beta} 3$$

We construct $I(2)$. *First,* $I(2)_2 = k$. *Now we have one path* $(1|\alpha|2)$. *So* $I(2)_1 = k$. *Then* $\psi_\alpha = [1]$. *We have no path from* 3 *to* 2. *So* $I(2)_3 = k$. $\psi_\beta = [1]$. *Thus*

$$I(2) = \; k \xrightarrow{1} k \xleftarrow{1} k$$

Example 6.2.10. *Let* Q *be the quiver*

$$\begin{tikzcd} 1 \arrow[rr] \arrow[dr] & & 3 \arrow[r] & 4 \\ & 2 \arrow[ur] & & \end{tikzcd}$$

Then

$$P(1) \cong \begin{tikzcd} k \arrow[rr, "{\left[\begin{smallmatrix}0\\1\end{smallmatrix}\right]}"] \arrow[dr, "1"'] & & k^2 \arrow[r, "{\left[\begin{smallmatrix}1&0\\0&1\end{smallmatrix}\right]}"] & k^2 \\ & k \arrow[ur, "{\left[\begin{smallmatrix}1\\0\end{smallmatrix}\right]}"'] & & \end{tikzcd}$$

and

$$I(4) \cong \begin{tikzcd} k^2 \arrow[rr, "{[0\ 1]}"] \arrow[dr, "{[1\ 0]}"'] & & k \arrow[r, "1"] & k \\ & k \arrow[ur, "1"'] & & \end{tikzcd}$$

Definition 6.2.11. *Let $Q = (Q_0, Q_1, s, t)$ be a quiver, and let $i \in Q_0$ be a vertex. We say that i is a* sink *if there is no arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$ with $s(\alpha) = i$.*
Equivalently, i is a sink if no arrow starts at i, that is, every arrow incident with i ends at i.

Definition 6.2.12. *Let $Q = (Q_0, Q_1, s, t)$ be a quiver, and let $i \in Q_0$ be a vertex. We say that i is a* source *if there is no arrow $\alpha \in Q_1$ with $t(\alpha) = i$.*
Equivalently, i is a source if no arrow ends at i, that is, every arrow incident with i starts at i.

Remark 6.2.13. *If $i \in Q_0$ is a sink, then $P(i) = S(i)$; if $i \in Q_0$ is a source, then $I(i) = S(i)$.*

Remark 6.2.14. *Suppose c is a path from i to j. Then we define*

$$\varphi_c : P(i)_i \to P(j)_j, (i|i) \mapsto c$$

If $c = (i|c_1, c_2, \ldots, c_n|j)$, then φ_c is given by

$$\varphi_c = c_n c_{n-1} \cdots c_1$$

We prove that $P(i)$ is projective object in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$ and $I(i)$ is injective object in $\operatorname{Rep} Q$. Recall that

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N$$

is exact if and only if

$$0 \longrightarrow \operatorname{Hom}(X, L) \xrightarrow{f_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, M) \xrightarrow{g_*} \operatorname{Hom}(X, N)$$

is exact for all $X \in \operatorname{Rep} Q$.

Lemma 6.2.15 (Yoneda). *Let Q be a quiver, let $i \in Q_0$, and let $X = (X_j, \varphi_\alpha)$ be a representation of Q. Then there is a natural isomorphism*

$$\operatorname{Hom}(P(i), X) \cong X_i.$$

More precisely, the map

$$\Phi : \operatorname{Hom}(P(i), X) \longrightarrow X_i, \qquad f \longmapsto f_i(e_i)$$

is a vector space isomorphism, where e_i denotes the lazy path at the vertex i.

Proof. Recall that the projective representation $P(i)$ is defined by

$$P(i)_j = \sum_{p:i\to j} k\,p$$

for each vertex $j \in Q_0$, that is, $P(i)_j$ has as a basis all paths from i to j. For an arrow $\alpha : j \to \ell$, the linear map

$$P(i)_\alpha : P(i)_j \to P(i)_\ell$$

is given on basis elements by concatenation:

$$P(i)_\alpha(p) = \alpha p$$

for every path $p : i \to j$.

We define

$$\Phi : \mathrm{Hom}(P(i), X) \to X_i, \qquad f \mapsto f_i(e_i).$$

We first show that Φ is injective. Let $f : P(i) \to X$ be a morphism such that

$$f_i(e_i) = 0.$$

We claim that $f = 0$. Indeed, let $j \in Q_0$, and let $p : i \to j$ be any path. Since p is a basis element of $P(i)_j$, it is enough to show that

$$f_j(p) = 0.$$

But by construction of $P(i)$, the basis element $p \in P(i)_j$ is obtained from $e_i \in P(i)_i$ by following the path p. Hence, if we write

$$p = \alpha_r \cdots \alpha_1,$$

then

$$p = P(i)_{\alpha_r} \cdots P(i)_{\alpha_1}(e_i).$$

Since f is a morphism of representations, it commutes with all arrow maps, so

$$f_j(p) = f_j\big(P(i)_{\alpha_r} \cdots P(i)_{\alpha_1}(e_i)\big) = \varphi_{\alpha_r} \cdots \varphi_{\alpha_1}\big(f_i(e_i)\big) = 0.$$

Thus $f_j = 0$ for every j, hence $f = 0$. Therefore Φ is injective.

Next we show that Φ is surjective. Let $x \in X_i$. We define a morphism

$$f^x : P(i) \to X$$

as follows. For each vertex $j \in Q_0$, define a linear map

$$f_j^x : P(i)_j \to X_j$$

on a basis element $p : i \to j$ by

$$f_j^x(p) := X_p(x),$$

where $X_p : X_i \to X_j$ denotes the composition of the structure maps of X along the path p. In particular,

$$f_i^x(e_i) = x.$$

Extending linearly gives a well-defined linear map on $P(i)_j$.

We check that $f^x = (f_j^x)_j$ is a morphism of representations. Let $\alpha : j \to \ell$ be an arrow, and let $p : i \to j$ be a basis element of $P(i)_j$. Then

$$f_\ell^x\big(P(i)_\alpha(p)\big) = f_\ell^x(\alpha p) = X_{\alpha p}(x) = \varphi_\alpha\big(X_p(x)\big) = \varphi_\alpha\big(f_j^x(p)\big).$$

Hence

$$f_\ell^x \circ P(i)_\alpha = \varphi_\alpha \circ f_j^x,$$

so f^x is indeed a morphism $P(i) \to X$.

Finally,

$$\Phi(f^x) = f_i^x(e_i) = x,$$

so Φ is surjective.

Therefore Φ is a vector space isomorphism:

$$\mathrm{Hom}(P(i), X) \cong X_i.$$

The construction is natural in X, so this is a natural isomorphism. □

Proposition 6.2.16. *Let $g : M \to N$ be a surjective morphism between representations of Q, and let $P(i)$ be the projective representation at vertex i. Then the map*

$$g_* : \mathrm{Hom}(P(i), M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(P(i), N)$$

is surjective.

In other words, if $f : P(i) \to N$ is any morphism, then there exists a morphism $h : P(i) \to M$ such that the diagram

$$\begin{tikzcd}
& P(i) \arrow[dl, "h"'] \arrow[d, "f"] & \\
M \arrow[r, "g"] & N \arrow[r] & 0
\end{tikzcd}$$

commutes, that is,

$$f = g \circ h = g_*(h).$$

Proof. Let $f : P(i) \to N$ be any morphism. We must show that there exists a morphism $h : P(i) \to M$ such that
$$g \circ h = f.$$

Recall that for the projective representation $P(i)$, we have the natural isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}(P(i), X) \cong X_i$$

for every representation X, given by sending a morphism $\varphi : P(i) \to X$ to its component at the vertex i evaluated at the trivial path e_i.

Apply this to $X = M$ and $X = N$. Under these identifications, the map

$$g_* : \mathrm{Hom}(P(i), M) \to \mathrm{Hom}(P(i), N), \qquad h \mapsto g \circ h,$$

corresponds exactly to the linear map

$$g_i : M_i \to N_i.$$

Since $g : M \to N$ is surjective as a morphism of representations, each component

$$g_j : M_j \to N_j$$

is surjective, in particular
$$g_i : M_i \to N_i$$
is surjective.

Now the morphism $f : P(i) \to N$ corresponds to an element of N_i. Because g_i is surjective, this element lifts to some element of M_i. Again by the isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}(P(i), M) \cong M_i,$$

this element determines a morphism $h : P(i) \to M$. By construction, its image under

$$g_* : \mathrm{Hom}(P(i), M) \to \mathrm{Hom}(P(i), N)$$

is exactly f. Hence
$$g \circ h = f.$$

Therefore g_* is surjective. ☐

Corollary 6.2.17. *If*

$$0 \longrightarrow L \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow P \longrightarrow 0$$

is exact, P projective. Then this sequence is split exact.

Proof. Since P is projective, by definition the map

$$g_* : \mathrm{Hom}(P, M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(P, P), \qquad h \longmapsto g \circ h$$

is surjective.

In particular, taking the identity morphism

$$1_P \in \mathrm{Hom}(P, P),$$

there exists a morphism

$$s : P \to M$$

such that

$$g \circ s = 1_P.$$

Thus s is a section of g, so g is a split epimorphism.

Hence

$$M \cong L \oplus P,$$

and therefore the short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow L \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} P \longrightarrow 0$$

is split exact. □

Lemma 6.2.18. *Let Q be a quiver, let $i \in Q_0$, and let $I(i)$ be the injective representation at the vertex i. Then for every representation $X = (X_j, \varphi_\alpha)$ of Q, there is a natural isomorphism*

$$\mathrm{Hom}(X, I(i)) \cong X_i.$$

More precisely, the map

$$\Phi : \mathrm{Hom}(X, I(i)) \longrightarrow X_i$$

defined by sending a morphism $f : X \to I(i)$ to the element of X_i corresponding to the component f_i is an isomorphism.

Proof. This is dual to the projective case. The injective representation $I(i)$ represents the functor

$$X \longmapsto X_i.$$

Hence there is a natural isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}(X, I(i)) \cong X_i.$$

More concretely, one may define the inverse map as follows: for each $x \in X_i$, there exists a unique morphism

$$f^x : X \to I(i)$$

whose component at the vertex i corresponds to x. Thus the correspondence

$$f \longmapsto f_i$$

identifies $\mathrm{Hom}(X, I(i))$ with X_i.

Therefore

$$\mathrm{Hom}(X, I(i)) \cong X_i.$$

The construction is natural in X. $\square$

Proposition 6.2.19. *Let $f : M \to N$ be an injective morphism between representations of Q, and let $I(i)$ be the injective representation at the vertex i. Then the map*

$$f^* : \mathrm{Hom}(N, I(i)) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(M, I(i)), \qquad h \longmapsto h \circ f$$

is surjective.

In other words, if $g : M \to I(i)$ is any morphism, then there exists a morphism $h : N \to I(i)$ such that the diagram

$$\begin{tikzcd} 0 \arrow[r] & M \arrow[r, "f"] \arrow[dr, "g"'] & N \arrow[d, "h"] \\ & & I(i) \end{tikzcd}$$

commutes, that is,

$$g = h \circ f = f^*(h).$$

Proof. Consider the natural isomorphisms

$$\mathrm{Hom}(N, I(i)) \cong N_i, \qquad \mathrm{Hom}(M, I(i)) \cong M_i$$

from Lemma 6.2.18.

Under these identifications, the map

$$f^* : \mathrm{Hom}(N, I(i)) \to \mathrm{Hom}(M, I(i))$$

corresponds exactly to the linear map

$$f_i : M_i \to N_i$$

viewed contravariantly, that is, to the map induced by precomposition.

Since $f : M \to N$ is injective as a morphism of representations, each component

$$f_j : M_j \to N_j$$

is injective, in particular

$$f_i : M_i \to N_i$$

is injective.

Now let

$$g : M \to I(i)$$

be any morphism. Under the isomorphism

$$\mathrm{Hom}(M, I(i)) \cong M_i,$$

the morphism g corresponds to an element of M_i. Since $I(i)$ is injective, equivalently by the dual of the projective argument, this element extends across the inclusion

$$f_i : M_i \hookrightarrow N_i.$$

Hence there exists an element of N_i mapping to the given element of M_i, and therefore a morphism

$$h : N \to I(i)$$

such that

$$h \circ f = g.$$

Thus f^* is surjective. $\square$

Corollary 6.2.20. *Let*

$$0 \longrightarrow I \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

be a short exact sequence in $\mathrm{Rep}\, Q$*. If* I *is injective, then this sequence is split exact.*

Proof. Since I is injective, by definition the map

$$f^* : \mathrm{Hom}(M, I) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(I, I), \qquad h \longmapsto h \circ f$$

is surjective.

In particular, taking the identity morphism

$$1_I \in \mathrm{Hom}(I, I),$$

there exists a morphism

$$r : M \to I$$

such that

$$r \circ f = 1_I.$$

Thus r is a retraction of f, so f is a split monomorphism.

Hence

$$M \cong I \oplus N,$$

and therefore the short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow I \xrightarrow{f} M \xrightarrow{g} N \longrightarrow 0$$

is split exact. $\square$

Obviously, $S(i)$ are irreducible.

Chapter 7

Lecture 7

7.1 Simple Representations; Sinks and Sources

Proposition 7.1.1. *Let Q be a quiver without oriented cycles. Then $S(i)$ are only simple representations of Q.*

Proof. It is clear that each representation $S(i)$ is simple: indeed, its only subrepresentations are 0 and $S(i)$ itself, since $S(i)$ is one-dimensional at the vertex i and zero at every other vertex.

Conversely, let $M = (M_j, \varphi_\alpha)$ be a simple representation of Q. We show that $M \cong S(i)$ for some vertex $i \in Q_0$.

Since $M \neq 0$, there exists at least one vertex $i \in Q_0$ such that $M_i \neq 0$. Because Q has no oriented cycles and is finite, we may choose such a vertex i with the additional property that

$$M_j = 0$$

for every arrow

$$i \xrightarrow{\alpha} j.$$

In other words, among the vertices where M is nonzero, we choose one from which no arrow goes to another nonzero vertex.

Now define a morphism

$$f : S(i) \longrightarrow M$$

as follows. At the vertex i, choose any nonzero linear map

$$f_i : S(i)_i \cong k \longrightarrow M_i.$$

Since $f_i \neq 0$ and $S(i)_i \cong k$ is one-dimensional, f_i is injective. For every vertex $j \neq i$, define

$$f_j = 0 : S(i)_j = 0 \longrightarrow M_j.$$

We claim that f is a morphism of representations. Let α be any arrow.

If $\alpha : \ell \to i$, then $S(i)_\ell = 0$, so both compositions in the square are zero.

If $\alpha : i \to j$, then by the choice of i we have $M_j = 0$, and since $S(i)_j = 0$, again both compositions are zero.

If α is any other arrow, then both source and target spaces in $S(i)$ are zero, so the commutativity is automatic.

Hence f is indeed a morphism of representations. Moreover, $f \neq 0$, and since $S(i)$ is simple, f is injective. Thus $S(i)$ is a nonzero subrepresentation of M.

But M is simple, so its only nonzero subrepresentation is itself. Therefore

$$M \cong S(i).$$

We have proved that every simple representation is isomorphic to $S(i)$ for some vertex $i \in Q_0$. Therefore the representations $S(i)$ are precisely the simple representations of Q. □

Proposition 7.1.2. *A vertex $i \in Q_0$ is a sink if and only if $P(i) = S(i)$ is simple; a vertex $i \in Q_0$ is a source if and only if $I(i) = S(i)$ is simple.*

Proof. We prove the two statements separately.

First, recall that for the projective representation $P(i)$, the vector space $P(i)_j$ has as a basis the set of all paths from i to j. In particular, $P(i)_i$ is one-dimensional, with basis given by the trivial path e_i.

We first show that i is a sink if and only if $P(i) = S(i)$.

Assume that i is a sink. Then there is no arrow starting at i. Hence the only path starting at i is the trivial path e_i. Therefore

$$P(i)_i \cong k, \qquad P(i)_j = 0 \quad \text{for all } j \neq i.$$

Thus $P(i)$ is concentrated at the single vertex i, where it is one-dimensional, and all arrow maps are zero. Hence

$$P(i) \cong S(i).$$

Since $S(i)$ is simple, it follows that $P(i) = S(i)$ is simple.

Conversely, assume that $P(i) = S(i)$ is simple. Then in particular

$$P(i)_j = 0 \qquad \text{for all } j \neq i.$$

If i were not a sink, there would exist an arrow

$$\alpha : i \to j$$

for some vertex $j \neq i$. But then α is a path from i to j, so it gives a basis element of $P(i)_j$. Hence $P(i)_j \neq 0$, a contradiction. Therefore i must be a sink.

Now consider the injective representation $I(i)$. By definition, $I(i)_j$ has as a basis the set of all paths from j to i. In particular, $I(i)_i$ is one-dimensional, with basis given by the trivial path e_i.

We show that i is a source if and only if $I(i) = S(i)$.

Assume that i is a source. Then there is no arrow ending at i. Hence the only path ending at i is the trivial path e_i. Therefore

$$I(i)_i \cong k, \qquad I(i)_j = 0 \quad \text{for all } j \neq i.$$

Thus $I(i)$ is concentrated at the single vertex i, where it is one-dimensional, and all arrow maps are zero. Hence

$$I(i) \cong S(i).$$

So $I(i) = S(i)$ is simple.

Conversely, assume that $I(i) = S(i)$ is simple. Then

$$I(i)_j = 0 \qquad \text{for all } j \neq i.$$

If i were not a source, there would exist an arrow

$$\alpha : j \to i$$

for some vertex $j \neq i$. But then α is a path from j to i, so it gives a basis element of $I(i)_j$. Hence $I(i)_j \neq 0$, a contradiction. Therefore i must be a source.

This proves the proposition. □

7.2 Direct Sums of Projectives and Injectives; Indecomposability

Proposition 7.2.1.

(1) Let P and P' be representations of Q. Then

$$P \oplus P' \text{ is projective} \iff P \text{ and } P' \text{ are projective.}$$

(2) Let I and I' be representations of Q. Then

$$I \oplus I' \text{ is injective} \iff I \text{ and } I' \text{ are injective.}$$

Proof. We prove both statements.

(1) Projective case.

($\Rightarrow$) Assume that $P \oplus P'$ is projective. We show that P and P' are projective.

Let $g : M \to N$ be a surjective morphism in $\operatorname{rep} Q$, and let $f : P \to N$ be any morphism. Let

$$pr_1 : P \oplus P' \to P \qquad \text{and} \qquad i_1 : P \to P \oplus P'$$

be the canonical projection and injection, respectively. Since $P \oplus P'$ is projective, there exists a morphism

$$h : P \oplus P' \to M$$

such that

$$g \circ h = f \circ pr_1.$$

Composing with i_1, we obtain

$$g \circ h \circ i_1 = f \circ pr_1 \circ i_1 = f \circ 1_P = f.$$

Thus $h' := h \circ i_1 : P \to M$ satisfies $g \circ h' = f$, so P is projective. By symmetry, P' is also projective.

$$\begin{tikzcd}
& P \oplus P' \arrow[d, shift right, "pr_1"'] \arrow[ddl, "h"'] & \\
& P \arrow[u, shift right, "i_1"'] \arrow[d, "f"] \arrow[dl, "h'"] & \\
M \arrow[r, "g"'] & N \arrow[r] & 0
\end{tikzcd}$$

($\Leftarrow$) Assume that both P and P' are projective. We show that $P \oplus P'$ is projective.

Let $g : M \to N$ be a surjective morphism in $\operatorname{rep} Q$, and let

$$f : P \oplus P' \to N$$

be any morphism. Let

$$i_1 : P \to P \oplus P', \qquad i_2 : P' \to P \oplus P'$$

be the canonical injections. Since P is projective, there exists a morphism

$$h_1 : P \to M$$

such that

$$g \circ h_1 = f \circ i_1.$$

Similarly, since P' is projective, there exists a morphism

$$h_2 : P' \to M$$

such that

$$g \circ h_2 = f \circ i_2.$$

Define

$$h = (h_1, h_2) : P \oplus P' \to M$$

by

$$h(p, p') = h_1(p) + h_2(p').$$

Then for every $(p, p') \in P \oplus P'$,

$$g \circ h(p, p') = g(h_1(p)) + g(h_2(p')) = f(i_1(p)) + f(i_2(p')) = f(p, p').$$

Hence $g \circ h = f$, and therefore $P \oplus P'$ is projective.

$$\begin{tikzcd}
P \arrow[d, "i_1"'] \arrow[dr, dashed, "h_1"] & & P' \arrow[d, "i_2"] \arrow[dl, dashed, "h_2"'] \\
P \oplus P' \arrow[r, dashed, "h"'] \arrow[dr, "f"'] & M \arrow[d, "g"] & P \oplus P' \arrow[l, dashed, "h"] \arrow[dl, "f"] \\
& N \arrow[d] & \\
& 0 &
\end{tikzcd}$$

(2) Injective case.

($\Rightarrow$) Assume that $I \oplus I'$ is injective. We show that I and I' are injective.

Let $f : M \to N$ be an injective morphism in $\operatorname{rep} Q$, and let $g : M \to I$ be any morphism. Let

$$i_1 : I \to I \oplus I' \qquad \text{and} \qquad pr_1 : I \oplus I' \to I$$

be the canonical injection and projection, respectively. Since $I \oplus I'$ is injective, there exists a morphism

$$h : N \to I \oplus I'$$

such that

$$h \circ f = i_1 \circ g.$$

Composing with pr_1, we obtain

$$pr_1 \circ h \circ f = pr_1 \circ i_1 \circ g = 1_I \circ g = g.$$

Thus $h' := pr_1 \circ h : N \to I$ satisfies $h' \circ f = g$, so I is injective. By symmetry, I' is also injective.

$$\begin{tikzcd}
0 \arrow[r] & M \arrow[r, "f"] \arrow[d, "g"'] & N \arrow[dl, dashed, "h"'] \arrow[ddl, dashed, "h'"] \\
& I \oplus I' \arrow[d, shift right, "pr_1"'] & \\
& I \arrow[u, shift right, "i_1"'] &
\end{tikzcd}$$

($\Leftarrow$) Assume that both I and I' are injective. We show that $I \oplus I'$ is injective.

Let $f : M \to N$ be an injective morphism in $\operatorname{rep} Q$, and let

$$g : M \to I \oplus I'$$

be any morphism. Let

$$pr_1 : I \oplus I' \to I, \qquad pr_2 : I \oplus I' \to I'$$

be the canonical projections, and define

$$g_1 = pr_1 \circ g : M \to I, \qquad g_2 = pr_2 \circ g : M \to I'.$$

Since I is injective, there exists a morphism

$$h_1 : N \to I$$

such that

$$h_1 \circ f = g_1.$$

Similarly, since I' is injective, there exists a morphism

$$h_2 : N \to I'$$

such that

$$h_2 \circ f = g_2.$$

Define

$$h = \begin{pmatrix} h_1 \\ h_2 \end{pmatrix} : N \to I \oplus I'$$

by

$$h(n) = (h_1(n), h_2(n)).$$

Then for every $m \in M$,

$$h \circ f(m) = \big(h_1(f(m)), h_2(f(m))\big) = \big(g_1(m), g_2(m)\big) = g(m).$$

Hence $h \circ f = g$, and therefore $I \oplus I'$ is injective.

$$\begin{tikzcd}
 & 0 \arrow[d] & \\
 & M \arrow[dl, "g"'] \arrow[d, "f"] \arrow[dr, "g"] & \\
I \oplus I' \arrow[d, "pr_1"'] & N \arrow[l, dashed, "h"] \arrow[r, dashed, "h"'] \arrow[dl, dashed, "h_1"] \arrow[dr, dashed, "h_2"'] & I \oplus I' \arrow[d, "pr_2"] \\
I & & I'
\end{tikzcd}$$

□

Proposition 7.2.2. *The representations $S(i)$, $P(i)$, and $I(i)$ are indecomposable.*

Proof. For $S(i)$ this follows directly from the fact that $S(i)$ is simple. Let us prove the result for the projective representation

$$P(i) = \big(P(i)_j, \varphi_\alpha\big)_{j\in Q_0,\ \alpha\in Q_1}.$$

Since Q has no oriented cycles, we have $P(i)_i = k$. Suppose that

$$P(i) = M \oplus N$$

for some $M, N \in \operatorname{rep} Q$. Then we may suppose without loss of generality that $P(i)_i = M_i$ and $N_i = 0$. Let ℓ be a vertex of Q such that $N_\ell \neq 0$. Now, $P(i)_\ell$ has a basis consisting of the paths from i to ℓ in Q. Let

$$c = (i \mid \beta_1, \dots, \beta_s \mid \ell)$$

be such a path.

Let

$$\varphi_c = \varphi_{\beta_s} \cdots \varphi_{\beta_1}$$

denote the composition of the linear maps of the representation $P(i)$ along the path c. Then, since $P(i)$ is the direct sum of M and N, the map

$$\varphi_c : M_i \oplus 0 \longrightarrow M_\ell \oplus N_\ell$$

sends the unique basis element e_i of M_i to an element $\varphi_c(e_i)$ of M_ℓ. But we know that $\varphi_c(e_i) = c$; thus every basis element c of $P(i)_\ell$ lies in M_ℓ, a contradiction.

The proof for $I(i)$ is similar. □

Chapter 8

Lecture 8

8.1 Projective and Injective Resolutions

Definition 8.1.1. *Let M be a representation of Q.*

1. *A* projective resolution *of M is an exact sequence*

$$\cdots \longrightarrow P_3 \longrightarrow P_2 \longrightarrow P_1 \longrightarrow P_0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0,$$

where each P_i is a projective representation.

2. *An* injective resolution *of M is an exact sequence*

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow I_0 \longrightarrow I_1 \longrightarrow I_2 \longrightarrow I_3 \longrightarrow \cdots,$$

where each I_i is an injective representation.

Theorem 8.1.2. *Let $M = (M_i, M_\alpha)$ be a representation of a quiver Q.*

1. *There exists a projective resolution of M of the form*

$$0 \longrightarrow P_1 \longrightarrow P_0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow 0.$$

2. *There exists an injective resolution of M of the form*

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow I_0 \longrightarrow I_1 \longrightarrow 0.$$

Proof. We will show only (1), and to achieve this, we will construct the so-called standard projective resolution of M. Let

$$M = (M_i, \varphi_i),$$

and denote by d_i the dimension of M_i. Define

$$P_1 = \bigoplus_{\alpha \in Q_1} d_{s(\alpha)} P(t(\alpha)), \qquad P_0 = \bigoplus_{i \in Q_0} d_i P(i),$$

where $d_i P(i)$ stands for the direct sum of d_i copies of $P(i)$.

Before defining the morphisms of the projective resolution, let us examine the representations P_0 and P_1. For every vector space M_i, we have $d_i = \dim M_i$ copies of $P(i)$ in P_0. The natural map g from P_0 to M will send the d_i copies of the constant path e_i in P_0 to a basis of M_i. Now in each copy of $P(i)$, the kernel of the map g contains a copy of $P(t(\alpha))$ for every α that starts at i. So, for every arrow α with $s(\alpha) = i$, we have $d_{s(\alpha)}$ copies of $P(t(\alpha))$ in the kernel of g, which justifies the definition of P_1.

To define the morphisms of the projective resolution, we introduce specific bases for each of the representations P_1, P_0 and M as follows: For each $i \in Q_0$, let $\{m_{i1}, \ldots, m_{id_i}\}$ be a basis for M_i, and thus

$$B'' = \{m_{ij} \mid i \in Q_0,\ j = 1, 2, \ldots, d_i\}$$

is a basis for M. Taking the standard bases for the projective representations, the set

$$B = \{c_{ij} \mid i \in Q_0,\ c_i \text{ a path with } s(c_i) = i, \text{ and } j = 1, \ldots, d_i\}$$

is a basis for P_0; and the set

$$B' = \{b_{\alpha j} \mid \alpha \in Q_1,\ b_\alpha \text{ a path with } s(b_\alpha) = t(\alpha), \text{ and } j = 1, \ldots, d_{s(\alpha)}\}$$

is a basis for P_1. Define a map g on the basis B by

$$g(c_{ij}) = \varphi_{c_i}(m_{ij}) \in M_{t(c_i)}$$

and extend g linearly to P_1. Define the map f on the basis B' by

$$f(b_{\alpha j}) = (\alpha b_\alpha)_j - b_\alpha^M,$$

where αb_α is the path from $s(\alpha)$ to $t(b_\alpha)$ given by the composition of α and b_α, and

$$b_\alpha^M = \sum_{\ell=1}^{d_{t(\alpha)}} \theta_\ell \, b_{\alpha\ell},$$

where the θ_ℓ are the scalars that occur when writing $\varphi_\alpha(m_{s(\alpha)j})$ in the basis $\{m_{t(\alpha)\ell} \mid \ell = 1, \ldots, d_{t(\alpha)}\}$ of $M_{t(\alpha)}$; thus

$$\varphi_\alpha(m_{s(\alpha)j}) = \sum_{\ell=1}^{d_{t(\alpha)}} \theta_\ell m_{t(\alpha)\ell}. \tag{2.2}$$

We will now prove that the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \bigoplus_{\alpha \in Q_1} d_{s(\alpha)} P(t(\alpha)) \xrightarrow{f} \bigoplus_{i \in Q_0} d_i P(i) \xrightarrow{g} M \longrightarrow 0 \tag{2.3}$$

is exact.

g is surjective, because for any basis vector m_{ij} of M, we have $m_{ij} = g(e_{ij})$, where e_i is

the constant path at vertex i.

$\ker g \supset \operatorname{im} f$: It suffices to show that $g \circ f(b_{\alpha j}) = 0$ for any $b_{\alpha j}$ in the basis B'. We compute

$$\begin{aligned} g(f(b_{\alpha j})) &= g\big((\alpha b_\alpha)_j - b_\alpha^M\big) \\ &= \varphi_{\alpha b_\alpha}(m_{s(\alpha)j}) - \varphi_{b_\alpha}\Big(\sum_\ell \theta_\ell m_{t(\alpha)\ell}\Big) \\ &= \varphi_{b_\alpha}\Big(\varphi_\alpha(m_{s(\alpha)j}) - \sum_\ell \theta_\ell m_{t(\alpha)\ell}\Big) \\ &= \varphi_{b_\alpha}(0) \\ &= 0, \end{aligned}$$

where the next to last equation follows from (2.2).

$\ker g \subset \operatorname{im} f$: First note that any $x \in \bigoplus_{i \in Q_0} d_i P(i)$ can be written as a linear combination of the basis B; thus

$$x = \sum_{c_{ij} \in B} \lambda_{c_{ij}} c_{ij} = x_0 + \sum_{c_{ij} \in B \setminus B_0} \lambda_{c_{ij}} c_{ij},$$

where B_0 is the subset of B consisting of constant paths (together with a choice of j),

$$B_0 = \{e_{ij} \mid i \in Q_0,\ j = 1, \dots, d_i\},$$

and

$$x_0 = \sum_{e_{ij} \in B_0} \lambda_{e_{ij}} e_{ij}.$$

Any nonconstant path is the product of an arrow and another path; thus

$$x = x_0 + \sum_{c_{ij} \colon c_i = \alpha b_\alpha} \lambda_{c_{ij}} (\alpha b_\alpha)_j,$$

and using the definition of f, we get

$$x = x_0 + \sum_{c_{ij} \colon c_i = \alpha b_\alpha} \lambda_{c_{ij}} f(b_{\alpha j}) + \lambda_{c_{ij}} b_\alpha^M. \tag{2.4}$$

Let

$$x_1 = x_0 + \sum_{c_i = \alpha b_\alpha} \lambda_{c_{ij}} b_\alpha^M.$$

Note that $x - x_1 \in \operatorname{im} f$.

Define the degree of a linear combination of paths to be the length of the longest path that appears in it with nonzero coefficient. Note that $\deg x_1 < \deg x$ and $\deg x_0 = 0$.

Now let us suppose that $x \in \ker g$. We want to show that $x \in \operatorname{im} f$. Using (2.4) and the fact that $g \circ f = 0$, we get

$$0 = g(x) = g(x_1).$$

Summarizing, we have $x_1 \in \ker g$, $\deg x_1 < \deg x$ and $x - x_1 \in \operatorname{im} f$.

Now we repeat the argument with x_1 instead of x. We get $x_2 \in \ker g$, $\deg x_2 < \deg x_1 <$

$\deg x$, and $x - x_2 \in \operatorname{im} f$. Continuing like this, we will eventually get $x_h \in \ker g$, $x - x_h \in \operatorname{im} f$, and $\deg x_h = 0$; thus x_h is a linear combination of constant paths, say

$$x_h = \sum_{i,j} \mu_{ij} e_{ij},$$

for some $\mu_{ij} \in k$. By definition of g, we have

$$0 = g(x_h) = \sum_{i,j} \mu_{ij} m_{ij},$$

and since the m_{ij} form a basis of M, this implies that all μ_{ij} are zero. Hence $x_h = 0$ and thus $x \in \operatorname{im} f$.

f is injective. Suppose that

$$0 = f\Big(\sum \lambda_{b\alpha h} b_{\alpha h}\Big) = \sum \lambda_{b\alpha h}\big((\alpha b_\alpha)_h - b_\alpha^M\big).$$

Then

$$\sum \lambda_{b\alpha h}(\alpha b_\alpha)_h = \sum \lambda_{b\alpha h} b_\alpha^M = \sum \lambda_{b\alpha h} \sum \theta_\ell b_{\alpha\ell}.$$

Let i_0 be a source in M, that is, i_0 is such that there is no arrow $j \to i_0$ with $d_j \neq 0$. Note that such an i_0 exists since Q has no oriented cycles. Then, since each of the paths b_α starts at the endpoint of the arrow α, none of the paths b_α can go through i_0, and this shows that $\lambda_{b\alpha h}$ must be zero, for all arrows α with $s(\alpha) = i_0$. Now let i_1 be a source in $M \setminus i_0$, that is, i_1 is such that there is no arrow $j \to i_1$ with $j \neq i_0$ and $d_j \neq 0$. Since $\lambda_{b\alpha h} = 0$ for all arrows α with $s(\alpha) = i_0$, there is no path $b_{\alpha h}$ with $\lambda_{b\alpha h} \neq 0$ that goes through i_1. Continuing in this way, we show that every $\lambda_{b\alpha h} = 0$, since Q has only finitely many arrows. Thus f is injective. This concludes the proof of the exactness of the standard resolution (2.3). □

8.2 Examples; Covers, Envelopes, and Minimality

Example 8.2.1.

$$Q: \quad 1 \xrightarrow{\alpha} 2 \xleftarrow{\beta} 3$$

and let

$$M = \quad k^2 \xrightarrow{\phi_\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}} k^3 \xleftarrow[\phi_\beta = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}]{} k \ .$$

Thus

$$M_1 = k^2, \qquad M_2 = k^3, \qquad M_3 = k,$$

with

$$\phi_\alpha(x,y) = (x,y,x), \qquad \phi_\beta(z) = (0,0,z).$$

We now compute the standard projective presentation *of* M*.*

Proposition 8.2.2. *For the above representation* M*, the standard projective presentation is*

$$0 \longrightarrow P(2)^{\oplus 3} \xrightarrow{f} P(1)^{\oplus 2} \oplus P(2)^{\oplus 3} \oplus P(3) \xrightarrow{g} M \longrightarrow 0,$$

where g *and* f *are given explicitly below.*

Proof. Choose bases

$$M_1 = \langle m_{11}, m_{12} \rangle, \qquad M_2 = \langle m_{21}, m_{22}, m_{23} \rangle, \qquad M_3 = \langle m_{31} \rangle,$$

such that

$$\phi_\alpha(m_{11}) = m_{21} + m_{23}, \qquad \phi_\alpha(m_{12}) = m_{22}, \qquad \phi_\beta(m_{31}) = m_{23}.$$

Since

$$\dim M_1 = 2, \qquad \dim M_2 = 3, \qquad \dim M_3 = 1,$$

the standard construction gives

$$P_0 = \bigoplus_{i \in Q_0} (\dim M_i)\, P(i) = P(1)^{\oplus 2} \oplus P(2)^{\oplus 3} \oplus P(3),$$

and

$$P_1 = \bigoplus_{\gamma \in Q_1} (\dim M_{s(\gamma)})\, P(t(\gamma)) = (\dim M_1) P(2) \oplus (\dim M_3) P(2) = P(2)^{\oplus 3}.$$

Recall that for the quiver $1 \to 2 \leftarrow 3$,

$$\begin{aligned}
P(1) &= \; k \xrightarrow{\;1\;} k \longleftarrow 0 \;, \\
P(2) &= \; 0 \longrightarrow k \longleftarrow 0 \;, \\
P(3) &= \; 0 \longrightarrow k \xleftarrow{\;1\;} k \;.
\end{aligned}$$

We now describe $g : P_0 \to M$.
At vertex 1, only the two copies of $P(1)$ contribute, so

$$g_1 : k^2 \longrightarrow k^2, \qquad g_1 = \mathrm{id}_{k^2}.$$

At vertex 3, only the copy of $P(3)$ contributes, so

$$g_3 : k \longrightarrow k, \qquad g_3 = \mathrm{id}_k.$$

At vertex 2, we have

$$(P_0)_2 \cong k^2 \oplus k^3 \oplus k.$$

Let

$$a_1, a_2$$

be the basis vectors at vertex 2 coming from the two copies of $P(1)$, let

$$e_1, e_2, e_3$$

be the basis vectors coming from the three copies of $P(2)$, and let

$$b$$

be the basis vector coming from $P(3)$. Then g_2 is determined by

$$\begin{aligned} g_2(a_1) &= m_{21} + m_{23}, & g_2(a_2) &= m_{22}, \\ g_2(e_1) &= m_{21}, & g_2(e_2) &= m_{22}, \\ g_2(e_3) &= m_{23}, & g_2(b) &= m_{23}. \end{aligned}$$

Hence, relative to the ordered basis

$$(a_1, a_2, e_1, e_2, e_3, b) \quad \text{of } (P_0)_2$$

and

$$(m_{21}, m_{22}, m_{23}) \quad \text{of } M_2,$$

the matrix of g_2 is

$$[g_2] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Next we describe $f : P_1 \to P_0$. Since $P_1 = P(2)^{\oplus 3}$, it is supported only at vertex 2. Let

$$x_1, x_2, x_3$$

be the standard basis of $(P_1)_2 \cong k^3$, where x_1, x_2 correspond to the two basis vectors of M_1 (hence to the arrow α), and x_3 corresponds to the basis vector of M_3 (hence to the arrow β).
By the standard formula,

$$f(b_{\alpha j}) = (\alpha b_\alpha)_j - b_\alpha^M, \qquad f(b_{\beta 1}) = (\beta b_\beta)_1 - b_\beta^M.$$

Here $b_\alpha = b_\beta = e_2$, the trivial path at vertex 2. Thus:

$$\phi_\alpha(m_{11}) = m_{21} + m_{23} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad f(x_1) = a_1 - e_1 - e_3,$$
$$\phi_\alpha(m_{12}) = m_{22} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad f(x_2) = a_2 - e_2,$$
$$\phi_\beta(m_{31}) = m_{23} \quad \Longrightarrow \quad f(x_3) = b - e_3.$$

Therefore, relative to the ordered basis

$$(x_1, x_2, x_3) \quad \text{of } (P_1)_2$$

and

$$(a_1, a_2, e_1, e_2, e_3, b) \quad \text{of } (P_0)_2,$$

the matrix of f_2 is

$$[f_2] = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

At vertices 1 and 3, the map f is zero, since P_1 has no component there. Hence the standard projective presentation of M is

$$0 \longrightarrow P(2)^{\oplus 3} \xrightarrow{f} P(1)^{\oplus 2} \oplus P(2)^{\oplus 3} \oplus P(3) \xrightarrow{g} M \longrightarrow 0.$$

This is exact by the general standard-resolution construction. $\square$

Remark 8.2.3. *There are other projective resolutions than the standard resolution.*

Example 8.2.4. *Let Q be the quiver*

$$1 \longrightarrow 2 \longleftarrow 3$$

and consider the representations

$$M = S(3) = 3 \qquad \textit{and} \qquad M' = \begin{smallmatrix} 1 & & 3 \\ & 2 & \end{smallmatrix}.$$

Then we have the standard projective resolutions:

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \end{smallmatrix} \longrightarrow 3 \longrightarrow 0$$

and

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \oplus 2 \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}1\\2\end{smallmatrix} \oplus \begin{smallmatrix}3\\2\end{smallmatrix} \oplus 2 \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}1&&3\\&2&\end{smallmatrix} \longrightarrow 0.$$

The second resolution is not minimal in the sense that one can eliminate a direct summand $S(2) = 2$ in each of the projective modules and still have a projective resolution:

$$0 \longrightarrow 2 \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}1\\2\end{smallmatrix} \oplus \begin{smallmatrix}3\\2\end{smallmatrix} \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}1&&3\\&2&\end{smallmatrix} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Example 8.2.5. *Let Q be the quiver*

$$\begin{tikzcd}
1 \arrow[r, "\alpha"] & 2 \arrow[r, "\beta"] \arrow[d, "\gamma"'] & 3 \\
& 4 &
\end{tikzcd}$$

and consider the representation

$$M = \begin{smallmatrix}&1&\\2&&2\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix}$$

given by

$$\begin{tikzcd}
k \arrow[r, "\left[\begin{smallmatrix}1\\0\end{smallmatrix}\right]"] & k^2 \arrow[r, "{[0\ 1]}"] \arrow[dr, "{[1\ 1]}"'] & k \\
& & k
\end{tikzcd}$$

Then we have the standard projective resolution:

$$0 \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}&2&\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \oplus (3 \oplus 3) \oplus (4 \oplus 4) \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}&1&\\&2&\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \oplus \begin{smallmatrix}&2&\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \oplus \begin{smallmatrix}&2&\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \oplus 3 \oplus 4 \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}&1&\\2&&2\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \longrightarrow 0.$$

Again, this resolution is not minimal in the sense that one can eliminate three direct summands in each of the projective modules and still have a projective resolution:

$$0 \longrightarrow 3 \oplus 4 \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}&1&\\&2&\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \oplus \begin{smallmatrix}&2&\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \longrightarrow \begin{smallmatrix}&1&\\2&&2\\3&&4\end{smallmatrix} \longrightarrow 0.$$

To make this notion of minimality more precise, we need the definitions of projective covers and injective envelopes.

Definition 8.2.6 (Projective cover and injective envelope)**.** *Let $M \in \operatorname{rep} Q$.*
A projective cover *of M is a projective representation P together with a surjective morphism*

$$g\colon P \to M$$

with the property that, whenever

$$g'\colon P' \to M$$

is a surjective morphism with P' projective, then there exists a surjective morphism

$$h\colon P' \to P$$

such that the diagram

$$\begin{tikzcd} P' \arrow[r, "h"] \arrow[dr, "g'"'] & P \arrow[d, "g"] \\ & M \end{tikzcd}$$

commutes, that is, $gh = g'$.
An injective envelope *of M is an injective representation I together with an injective morphism*

$$f\colon M \to I$$

with the property that, whenever

$$f'\colon M \to I'$$

is an injective morphism into an injective representation I', then there exists an injective morphism

$$h\colon I \to I'$$

such that the diagram

$$\begin{tikzcd} & M \arrow[dl, "f"'] \arrow[dr, "f'"] & \\ I \arrow[rr, "h"'] & & I' \end{tikzcd}$$

commutes, that is, $hf = f'$.

Definition 8.2.7 (Minimal projective and injective resolutions)**.** *A projective resolution*

$$\cdots \longrightarrow P_3 \xrightarrow{f_3} P_2 \xrightarrow{f_2} P_1 \xrightarrow{f_1} P_0 \xrightarrow{f_0} M \longrightarrow 0$$

is called minimal *if $f_0\colon P_0 \to M$ is a projective cover and*

$$f_i\colon P_i \to \ker f_{i-1}$$

is a projective cover, for every $i > 0$.
An injective resolution

$$0 \longrightarrow M \xrightarrow{f_0} I_0 \xrightarrow{f_1} I_1 \xrightarrow{f_2} I_2 \xrightarrow{f_3} I_3 \longrightarrow \cdots$$

is called minimal *if $f_0\colon M \to I_0$ is an injective envelope and, for every $i > 0$,*

$$f_i\colon \operatorname{coker} f_{i-1} \to I_i$$

is an injective envelope.